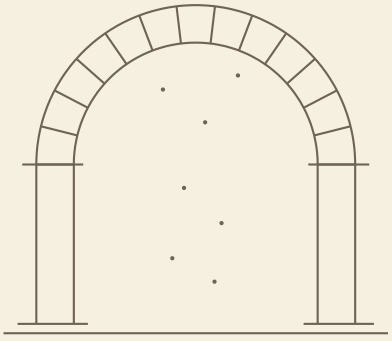
# Sejr

*a drop-in Nimble campaign in the City of Arches*

The city is thousands of years old and nobody controls its arches. Keys exist, and whoever holds one decides where an arch opens. Patrons hold plenty, so the city's politics are route politics: who can move people and goods wins. Out past the walls, the places nobody travels to any more are quietly going wrong.

You are professionals with lives of your own, thrown together on gigs. Each of you carries an arcanum you haven't figured out yet, and a place in the city to come home to. One gig a session, played by whoever shows up.




| | |
|---|---|
| **Players** | How we play · Make a hero · Arcana · Guilds |
| **Game master** | The episode · Rooms and people · Patrons · Trackers · Bia · Who's out there |
| **Appendices** | The deck in full · Forge an arcanum · Sheets |


*Runs on Nimble 2 (Core Rules 3.2, GM Guide 3.0). Anything not written here works as Nimble says. Sejr is an independent fan campaign set in the City of Arches.*

# How we play

*the table, the system, and what's different here*

## The table

- **One gig a session.** Three hours, whoever shows. Every session is a bottle episode that works for one player or a full table.
- **The arch is the door.** The map is drawn on the mat, and the arch is the way in and out of it.
- **Absent heroes are busy elsewhere in the city.** Their players tick an arcana ritual instead of losing ground.
- **Levels follow the group.** New and returning players join at the average group level, as the same hero with a beard.
- **Milestones.** The group levels every two or three episodes, so attendance never splits the party.
- **Renown** rises by 1 each episode and is capped at the average group level. It sets the Stage and how hard the rooms get.
- **Fail forward.** A failure moves a clock. It never ends the session.

## Nimble, for 5e players

Sejr runs on Nimble 2. If you know 5e you know most of it: the six familiar abilities fold into STR, DEX, INT and WIL, attacks always roll damage (a 1 on the Primary Die misses, the highest number crits and explodes), and on your turn you have three actions. Monsters don't: they move, use what's on their stat block, and their turn ends.

Anything this book doesn't say works as the Nimble Core Rules say.

## Gifts and traits

Every hero has two **gifts**, one word for each of their class's two key stats (Quick, Studied, Steady), and two **traits** (Proud, Loyal, Restless).

- **Invoke** a gift or trait in a dramatic moment for advantage. Once per hero per episode, at the GM's call.
- **Suffer** a trait: take disadvantage because of who you are, and tick your arcana ritual.

## Skills and specialties

The A5e skill list is the table's vocabulary (see Make a hero). When you roll, argue which Nimble skill applies from your sheet and the fiction. A stretch gets disadvantage, never a flat no.

A **specialty** gives advantage. You start with two, plus your INT if it's positive, and gain one more at levels 5, 9, 13 and 17.

**Shared history.** The first time two heroes share a gig, each may rewrite one life event to include the other and gain a specialty. At most two per hero, each with a different partner.

## Coming and going

The session opens with a **last time** line: one sentence per hero, so anyone who missed a week walks straight back in.

A hero returning after time away rolls on the **Beard** table.

| D6 | BEARD |
|---|---|
| 1 | A new scar, and the story behind it |
| 2 | A debt to a patron who now wants something |
| 3 | A contact met on a solo gig |
| 4 | A rumor from a place no one visited, so reveal one Neglect clock |
| 5 | The holding changed while they were gone |
| 6 | The arcana stirred, so reveal one unexamined trait |

# Make a hero *fifteen minutes, then out the door*

## Make a hero

1. **Class.** Pick one, or roll d12 and reroll a 12. Note its two key stats.
2. **Ancestry.** Pick any from the Nimble books.
3. **Stats.** Pick an array and put the highest numbers in your key stats.
4. **Gifts and traits.** One gift word for each key stat; two traits.
5. **Three life events.** Origin, Youth, Recent. Answer the questions, pick one skill from each, and keep any tie you like as a thread.
6. **Specialties.** Two, plus INT if positive, in skills you picked.
7. **Arcanum.** Draw one, unexamined. Don't read the card yet.
8. **Holding or guild.** A place in the city, or your class guild.
9. **Look, habit, mark, secret.** Roll or pick.
10. **Level 1,** or the average group level. Then roll the first gig.

## Classes

| D12 | CLASS | KEY STATS |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Berserker | STR and DEX |
| 2 | Cheat | DEX and INT |
| 3 | Commander | STR and INT |
| 4 | Hunter | DEX and WIL |
| 5 | Mage | INT and WIL |
| 6 | Oathsworn | STR and WIL |
| 7 | Shadowmancer | INT and DEX |
| 8 | Shepherd | WIL and STR |
| 9 | Songweaver | WIL and INT |
| 10 | Stormshifter | WIL and DEX |
| 11 | Zephyr | DEX and STR |
| 12 | *Reroll* | |

## Stat arrays

| D3 | ARRAY |
|---|---|
| 1 | Standard (+2, +2, +0, -1) |
| 2 | Balanced (+2, +1, +1, +0) |
| 3 | Min-Max (+3, +1, -1, -1) |

## Ancestry

*pick, or roll d6: 1–5 common, 6 rare*

**Common.** Human, Dwarf, Elf, Halfling, Gnome.

**Rare.** Bunbun, Dragonborn, Fiendkin, Goblin, Kobold, Orc, Birdfolk, Celestial, Changeling, Crystalborn, Dryad, Shroomling, Half-Giant, Minotaur, Beastfolk, Oozeling, Construct, Planarbeing, Ratfolk, Stoatling, Turtlefolk, Wyrdling.

## Gift words

| STAT | WORDS |
|---|---|
| STR | Strong, Big, Brutish, Powerful, Muscled, Tough, Hardy, Enduring, Weathered, Rugged |
| DEX | Fast, Nimble, Quick, Dexterous, Agile |
| INT | Smart, Studied, Well-read, Astute, Cunning |
| WIL | Wise, Perceptive, Discerning, Prudent, Steady, Charismatic, Magnetic, Alluring, Affable, Natural leader |

## Traits

| D20 | TRAIT |
|---|---|
| 1 | Generous |
| 2 | Cold |
| 3 | Calm |
| 4 | Wary |
| 5 | Dutiful |
| 6 | Sly |
| 7 | Curious |
| 8 | Proud |
| 9 | Stubborn |
| 10 | Loyal |
| 11 | Reckless |
| 12 | Superstitious |
| 13 | Vain |
| 14 | Gentle |
| 15 | Bitter |
| 16 | Greedy |
| 17 | Devout |
| 18 | Restless |
| 19 | Honest |
| 20 | Jealous |

## Ties

*d4 for each life event*

| D4 | TIE |
|---|---|
| 1 | friend |
| 2 | patron |
| 3 | rival |
| 4 | adversary |

A tie is a named person: a friend, patron, rival or adversary. Keep it and it becomes a card on the thread board.

## Holding

Your place in the city, and what's odd about it.

| D8 | PLACE |
|---|---|
| 1 | a rented room at Korvela's Edge Apartments |
| 2 | a stall in Market Square |
| 3 | a back room at Sevenge and Gam's Public House |
| 4 | a boathouse below the Falls of the Three Gods |
| 5 | a keeper's lodge on the Cliffs of the Dead |
| 6 | a cellar with a door into the Lower Reaches |
| 7 | a shed in Sunset Grove |
| 8 | a loft near Vathrex's Forge |

| D6 | QUIRK |
|---|---|
| 1 | it leaks when it rains |
| 2 | the neighbor owes you a favor |
| 3 | there's a dormant arch in the cellar |
| 4 | the landlord answers to the Black Hand |
| 5 | it belonged to someone else last week |
| 6 | a ghost pays half the rent |

## Faction mark

| D10 | MARK |
|---|---|
| 1 | Golden Order brand, a sun burned on the forearm |
| 2 | Children of Ibraxus glyph, a spiral rune, faintly warm |
| 3 | Archkeeper token, a broken arch-shaped coin on a cord |
| 4 | Nameless King mark, an old symbol no one agrees on |
| 5 | Black Hand brand, an ink-black handprint on the neck |
| 6 | Mages of Kartan seal, wax pressed into the skin, still active |
| 7 | Revvian relic, jewelry from Sunken Revvia worn as a trophy |
| 8 | Deadlands dust, white ash rubbed in ritual patterns |
| 9 | Unknown, a symbol no one at the table recognizes |
| 10 | Two marks: roll twice more |

## Origin

*d12 · each gives a tag, two questions, a choice of two skills and a tie*

| D12 | EVENT |
|---|---|
| 1 | **Arch-born.** You stepped through an arch with no memory of before. What were you clutching? What did the one who met you write down? *Arcana or Culture.* |
| 2 | **Second Rise cast-off.** Your family held a villa on the Second Rise until something cost them it. What was lost? Who lives there now? *Persuasion or History.* |
| 3 | **Raised in the Reaches.** You grew up below, in the Lower Reaches. Who kept you fed, and at what price? Which door down there do you still avoid? *Stealth or Deception.* |
| 4 | **Crypt kin.** Your people tended the crypts on the Cliffs of the Dead. What did the dead teach you? Which tomb is your family forbidden to open? *Religion or Medicine.* |
| 5 | **Marsh folk.** You came from a fishing village in the Revlend Marshes. What did the water take from you? Why did you leave for the city? *Survival or Nature.* |
| 6 | **Hill farm.** Your family farmed the Doorish Hills and sold at the trade festivals. What did you see in the old forest that no one believed? *Animal Handling or Nature.* |
| 7 | **Deadlands crossing.** Your caravan crossed the Deadlands, and not everyone arrived. Who did you leave behind? What of theirs do you still carry? *Survival or Perception.* |
| 8 | **Forge child.** You grew up beside a forge or workshop. What did you make that you're still proud of? Who stole the design? *Engineering or Athletics.* |
| 9 | **Backstage brat.** You were raised behind the curtain at the Theater of Whispers. Which role did you play too well? Whose secret did you overhear? *Performance or Insight.* |
| 10 | **Knight's child.** A parent served the Golden Knights. Did they come home? What oath did they make you swear? *Athletics or Intimidation.* |
| 11 | **Tower foundling.** You were left at the foot of Kartan, Tower of the Arcane. Who raised you there, and why did they let you go? *Arcana or Investigation.* |
| 12 | **Festival born.** You were born to traders during a trade festival. What goods did your family carry? Where do your relatives roam now? *Culture or Persuasion.* |

# Youth

*d12 · each gives a tag, two questions, a choice of two skills and a tie*

| D12 | EVENT |
|---|---|
| 1 | **Key finder.** You found an arch key as a child. Where did it open? Who took it from you? *Investigation or Arcana*. |
| 2 | **Black Hand runner.** You carried messages for the Black Hand. What did you read that you shouldn't have? Do they think you still owe them? *Sleight of Hand or Deception*. |
| 3 | **Pulled from the cisterns.** You nearly drowned in the Lost Cisterns. Who or what pulled you out? What did you see under the water? *Athletics or Perception*. |
| 4 | **The friend who joined.** A friend joined the Children of Ibraxus. Did you follow, report them, or walk away? What did they give you at parting? *Religion or Insight*. |
| 5 | **Thrown-out apprentice.** You apprenticed to a trade in Market Square. Why did your master throw you out? Which tool did you keep? *Engineering or Culture*. |
| 6 | **Rooftop gang.** You ran the rooftops with a gang. Who fell? Who leads them now? *Acrobatics or Stealth*. |
| 7 | **Rumor seller.** You sold gossip at the Public Baths. Which rumor came true? Who paid you to start it? *Investigation or Persuasion*. |
| 8 | **Archkeepers' ward.** The Archkeepers took you in. Which arrival scared you most? Why did you leave their care? *Culture or Insight*. |
| 9 | **Grave digger.** You dug things up on the Cliffs of the Dead. What did you find that you couldn't sell? What still follows you? *Medicine or Stealth*. |
| 10 | **Pit fighter.** You fought for coin. Who did you beat that you shouldn't have? Who taught you to lose on purpose? *Athletics or Intimidation*. |
| 11 | **Back-alley healer.** You patched up people no one else would. Who died in your hands? Who owes you their life? *Medicine or Persuasion*. |
| 12 | **Stargazer.** You snuck into the Observatory of Infinite Skies. What did you see through the glass? Who caught you? *Nature or History*. |

# Recent

*d12 · each gives a tag, two questions, a choice of two skills and a tie*

| D12 | EVENT |
|---|---|
| 1 | **The last gig.** Your last job went wrong. Who didn't make it out? Who blames you? *Perception or Insight*. |
| 2 | **Won at cards.** You won your holding in a game at Sevenge and Gam's Public House. Who lost it? Do they want it back? *Sleight of Hand or Deception*. |
| 3 | **Patron's favor.** A patron set you up in your holding. What did you promise in return? When will they collect? *Persuasion or Culture*. |
| 4 | **Inheritance.** A relative left you the holding. Why you? What was locked inside? *History or Investigation*. |
| 5 | **Lying low.** You took the holding to disappear. From whom? Who knows where you are? *Stealth or Deception*. |
| 6 | **Beaten to the prize.** A rival crew beat you to a prize. Which crew? What did they take that was yours? *Survival or Intimidation*. |
| 7 | **Wrong arch.** An arch opened where it shouldn't, and you went through. Where did you end up? What came back with you? *Arcana or Survival*. |
| 8 | **Saved a stranger.** You pulled someone out of trouble. Who were they really? What did they leave you? *Medicine or Athletics*. |
| 9 | **Testimony.** You spoke against someone before the Golden Council or the Knights. Who? Who hasn't forgiven you? *Culture or Persuasion*. |
| 10 | **Debt paid.** Someone paid off your debts. Who? What do they want instead? *Persuasion or Deception*. |
| 11 | **Saw too much.** You witnessed something in the Lower Reaches. What was it? Who saw you see it? *Perception or Stealth*. |
| 12 | **How the arcanum came.** This is how your arcanum found you. Who had it before? Why didn't they want it? *Arcana or History*. |

## Look, habit, secret

| D20 | LOOK | HABIT | SECRET |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Balding | Spits | Hiding a fugitive |
| 2 | Stocky build | Always eating | Adores baby animals |
| 3 | Very tall | Moves quickly | Obsessed with fire |
| 4 | Beauty mark | Card tricks | In a religious cult |
| 5 | One eye | Prays aloud | Is a half-demon |
| 6 | Braided hair | Writes in diary | Was a wizard's apprentice |
| 7 | Muscular | Apologetic | Needlessly picks pockets |
| 8 | White hair | Slaps backs | Has a false identity |
| 9 | Scar on face | Drops things | Afraid of storms |
| 10 | Willowy build | Swears oaths | Has functional gills |
| 11 | Sweaty | Makes puns | In deep gambling debt |
| 12 | Cleft chin | Rare accent | Works as a smuggler |
| 13 | Frail | Easily spooked | Is a werewolf |
| 14 | Big eyebrows | Forgetful | Can actually smell lies |
| 15 | Tattooed | Speaks quietly | Cast out of a wealthy family |
| 16 | Floppy hat | Twitches | In love with a bartender |
| 17 | Gold tooth | Moves slowly | Left the Black Hand |
| 18 | Six fingers | Speaks loudly | Best friends with a noble |
| 19 | Very short | Swaggers | Retired crawler |
| 20 | Large nose | Smokes pipe | Has a pet basilisk |

## Skills and specialties

*the A5e list: pick from your life events, specialize in two*

| SKILL | SPECIALTIES |
|---|---|
| Acrobatics | balancing, escape artistry, swinging, tumbling |
| Animal Handling | calming, driving, farming, riding, training |
| Arcana | aberrations, constructs, detection, dragons, elementals, fey, forbidden knowledge, monstrosities, oozes, the planes |
| Athletics | climbing, jumping, lifting, running, swimming, throwing |
| Culture | etiquette, laws, linguistics, regional goods, streetwise, courtly manners, trade |
| Deception | boasting, ciphers, concealing emotions, mimicry |
| Engineering | architecture, chemistry, explosives, gadgetry, mathematics, mechanical traps, siegecraft |
| History | arts, empires, genealogy, legends, wars |
| Insight | detecting lies, reading emotions, sensing motives |
| Intimidation | authority, ferocity, interrogation, subtle threats, weapon displays |
| Investigation | appraisal, deciphering, forensics, gathering rumors, research, trapfinding |
| Medicine | animals, autopsy, diseases, herbalism, poisons |
| Nature | astronomy, beast lore, farming, fey, plant lore, weather |
| Perception | farsight, invisible objects, listening, scent |
| Performance | acting, composing, dancing, fine art, singing, speaking, writing |
| Persuasion | bribery, flattery, leadership, negotiation, peacemaking |
| Religion | alignment, celestials, cults, fiends, holy symbols, gods, morality, prophecy, undead |
| Sleight Of Hand | distraction, pickpocketing, legerdemain |
| Stealth | anonymity, camouflage, casing |
| Survival | dungeoneering, foraging, hunting, tracking, wayfinding |

# Arcana *the thing you carry and haven't worked out yet*

## What an arcanum is

Every hero starts with an arcanum: an object with a story and a power nobody has worked out yet. It starts **unexamined**. The card has six parts.

| PART | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| Object | What it looks like and where it came from. You know this much. |
| Unlock | A ritual of two or three deeds, ticked off in play. When the last box fills, the arcanum wakes. |
| Risk | What can go wrong on the final deed. |
| Resource | One tracker the powers spend or fill: pips, a d6 against accumulation, a toggle, or Wounds. |
| Powers | What it does once awake. At least one spends the resource; at least one is free or passive. |
| Escalation | What happens when the resource runs dry or overflows. Usually someone comes for it. |

## The arcana ritual

Each hero has one ritual track: the unlock boxes on their card. A box ticks when you do the deed in play. It also ticks once when you are absent, and once when you suffer a trait.

**The final box is only ever filled at the table.**

**University ranks** follow the ritual: *Novice* (unexamined), *Reader* (first trait revealed), *Wielder* (reliable use; patron jobs open), *Cracker* (broken open). Enrolling is optional. A student gets the job board, a trade chapter (a specialty and a holding upgrade) and arcana training between episodes. Without enrolling, an arcanum advances only through play.

## The draw

*d20, plus your legacy bonus*

| D20+ | ARCANUM |
|---|---|
| 1 | The Drowning Scale |
| 2 | The Hourglass of Borrowed Time |
| 3 | The Black Lotus Case |
| 4 | The Oath-Band |
| 5 | The Unpaid Favor |
| 6 | The Valkyrie's Feather |
| 7 | The Hellhide |
| 8 | The Kettle Plate |
| 9 | The Fairy Jar |
| 10 | The Apology Blade |
| 11 | The Rune Fragment |
| 12 | The Binding Linens |
| 13 | The Rusted Spear |
| 14 | The Derelict Harpoon |
| 15 | The Seekers' Provenance Ledger |
| 16 | The Black Goat's Tally-Stick |
| 17 | The Gate Chain |
| 18 | The Sown Teeth |
| 19 | The Hut on Hen's Legs |
| 20 | The Crafter's Codex |
| 21 | The Hexing Needles |
| 22 | The Bear-Lodge Horn |
| 23 | The Axe of Nine Eyes |

**Legacy bonus.** +1 for each of your heroes who died, retired, or was lost to an arcanum's Escalation, up to +3. Only a legacy bonus reaches 21–23.

## Faction rewards

*never drawn; handed out in play*

Class arcana come from your class guild at Journeyman rank (see Guilds). These five come from factions: The Forgotten Key, The Tide-Coat, The Pitch-Sap Harness, The Seven-Leaf Bracelet, The Arch-Watch Mirror.

# Table rules for arcana

## Off-screen refills

- Between episodes, each hero may make one refill off-screen, if it can be done inside the city. An off-screen refill restores 1 pip, or clears 1 point of accumulation, never the whole tracker: a vigil, a game of chance, a retelling to a new listener, a burial on the Cliffs of the Dead, hair, blood or cloth freely given by someone outside the party (Hexing Needles). Absent players may use it too, alongside their arcana-ritual tick.
- Say it in one sentence in the next episode's "last time" line.
- A refill that needs a place beyond the city needs a gig: the Revlend Marshes, Bloodrust Depths, the Lost Cavern of the Sundering Saurians, a world beyond an arch. That gig is a ready-made hero stake, and it takes the party to a region your Neglect clocks track.

## Readings

- Cards that read lies, motives, names or history give true answers. A true answer can still point at the wrong person: the liar was covering for someone, the owner sold it twice, the fear is about something else. Use it when two readers at one table would solve the gig in its first scene.

## Unknowns are rolls

- The campaign uses the City of Arches as a base and does its own thing. Nothing is canon until it hits the table.
- Cards marked *[TABLE ROLL]* in their notes lean on a fact the books don't settle (will the Observatory keep a lens overnight? does Vathrex sell coal?). Don't decide it in prep. The hero asks, and rolls Influence against the GM's sense of how likely it is. On a failure they find another way: sneak the lens in, steal the coal, pay someone who can.

## Escalations and the thread board

- An Escalation that brings a new threat writes a thread card only if the board has a free slot. If the board is full, it ticks the closest existing clock instead, and the threat arrives through that thread.

## Long durations

- A week, a lunar cycle, a full moon or a month on a card passes off-screen between episodes. Say it in the "last time" line. Absent players count it the same way.

# Guilds *the alternative to a holding*

## Holding or guild

At hero creation, take a holding or join your class's guild.

**A guild gives** a shared hall to Safe Rest in, one contact in the guild, one specialty from the guild's skill, and the guild as a door that sends you jobs.

**It costs** the guild's ask, every arc. Skip it for a whole arc and drop a rank; an Apprentice who skips it is out.

- Apprentice: you join here.
- Journeyman: meet the ask once and finish one gig for the guild; receive your class arcanum or the lead to it.
- Master: take a side in the guild's split and win the vote; you hold the guild's seat.

A guild gives its arcanum only to its own class. Another class gets the contact, the specialty and the jobs.

## The eleven guilds

| GUILD | TEACHES | ASKS | SPLIT | MASTER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **The Red Sand** Berserker · Arena of Blood, Lower Reaches | Might | one bout per arc; the guild takes a cut | the Blood (to the death, for the crowd's money) against the Sand (first blood, for the fighters) | Sytheria Redsong, the arena's master of ceremonies |
| **The House** Cheat · Guildred's Grotto, Lower Reaches | Finesse | a tithe of winnings | the House (honest odds, steady coin) against the Sharps (the guild's best are cheats) | Gleaming Guildred, the dwarf priest of luck, coin and merriment |
| **The Muster** Commander · Citadel of the Golden Knights | Influence (leadership) | answer one muster per arc | Knights-first (serve the Order) against the Free Captains (serve the highest bidder) | Joslyn Halfcloak, the Knights' contact for hired help |
| **The Wardens' Lodge** Hunter · the City Walls' gatehouse | Naturecraft (tracking) | one road patrol per arc | the Wardens (keep the roads) against the Bounty-takers (paid per head) | [your call], a Doorish Hills warden |
| **The University** Mage · Kartan, Tower of the Arcane | Arcana | your findings, published as its own | Traditionalists, Royalists and a New School (campaign overview) | Savandra Thricecursed, Kartan's overseer |
| **The Sworn Chapter** Oathsworn · the Queen's Palace chapel | Insight (detecting lies) | judge one dispute per arc | Throne-sworn (the queen) against Law-sworn (the Council's law); canon's plot by the queen's sister Atretha gives it a live edge | [your call] |
| **The Hollow Circle** Shadowmancer · the Hole in the World | Arcana (forbidden knowledge) | report any patron contact | the Bound (keep their patrons) against the Reavers (cut free) | [your call] |
| **The Sisters' Vigil** Shepherd · Temple of the Three Sisters | Examination (injuries) | one vigil per arc at a sickbed or grave (also the Bell's refill) | the Temple (heal for faith) against the Market (heal for coin) | Grace Ebonlight, who directs the temple |
| **The Whisper Company** Songweaver · Theater of Whispers | Influence (performance) | one performance per arc, and anything you overhear | the Players (perform) against the Whisperers (sell what they hear to Roselyn Zeshe) | Kaylex Thren, the dragonborn minstrel who runs it |
| **The Grove Circle** Stormshifter · Sunset Grove | Naturecraft (weather) | tend the Grove one night per arc | the Grove (keep the city's wild corner) against the Marsh (Revlender-born, and angry at the city) | Graysen One-Eye, the druid who oversees it |
| **The Last Studio** Zephyr · the studio in the Lower Reaches from the Wrappings card | Finesse | train one novice per arc | two senior students, each claiming the last teacher's line | none: the last teacher stopped mid-sentence |

## The Red Sand · Berserker

**Wants** to rule on trial by mortal combat for the Black Hand's condemned as a guild verdict, not as the Black Hand's mercy. **Teeth:** hunts fighters who fix bouts. **Keeps** the Bout Rolls, every fighter's record and how they lost. **Journeyman:** the lead: the Rolls name the fallen Borderlands fighter, and the guild has the collector's address. **Rival:** the Black Hand.

## The House · Cheat

**Wants** the Council's license for every game of chance in the city. **Teeth:** blacklists sharps who cheat members. **Keeps** the Marks Book, who is rich and who is desperate. **Journeyman:** the lead: the House knows the card sharp, and which Golden Knights shelf the die left. **Rival:** the Black Hand, which taxes every table.

## The Muster · Commander

**Wants** a standing commission for free companies, since the Knights are about two hundred strong and already hire outsiders. **Teeth:** strips the commission of captains who abandon their troops. **Keeps** the Muster Roll, every sellsword company and its debts. **Journeyman:** a writ to take the Battle Standard from the Museum of Worlds Beyond's vault. **Rival:** the Seekers of the Sun, who hold it.

## The Wardens' Lodge · Hunter

**Wants** bounty rights on the Suntouched Highway and Predalion's Belt. **Teeth:** hunts poachers and guides who sell out caravans. **Keeps** the Track Book, the sign of every beast and band on the roads. **Journeyman:** the Borderlands Tracking Cord itself; wardens took it off the merchant's body. **Rival:** smugglers on the Hills roads.

## The University · Mage

**Wants** a monopoly: open lectures, then licensing, then the only key-readers in the city (campaign overview). **Teeth:** an enforcement wing of ex-adventurers (campaign overview). **Keeps** the Laboratories of Kartan. **Journeyman:** the name of the pawn shop holding the Cracked Lens of Kartan; the University reported it stolen, and lets a Journeyman who recovers it keep it on loan. **Rival:** the Archkeepers.

## The Sworn Chapter · Oathsworn

**Wants** sworn knights recognized as judges in their own right. **Teeth:** tries oathbreakers. **Keeps** the Book of Oaths, every oath sworn before the Golden Throne. **Journeyman:** a lead to the old court ruin in Sunken Revvia where the Broken Verdict lies. **Rival:** the Golden Council.

## The Hollow Circle · Shadowmancer

**Wants** pacts made lawful, so a pact-bound caster is not a criminal by default. **Teeth:** hunts members whose patrons come through. **Keeps** the Margin Book, every patron's known terms. **Journeyman:** the address of the sealed room where the Hollow Contract lies. **Rival:** the Children of Ibraxus, who recruit the same people.

## The Sisters' Vigil · Shepherd

**Wants** the right to tend every dying body in the city, the Lower Reaches included. **Teeth:** hunts body-sellers and false healers. **Keeps** the Roll of the Dead, who is buried where on the Cliffs. **Journeyman:** where the Bell of the Three Sisters is; the temple never consecrated it, and the Vigil lends it to the member who brings it in. **Rival:** the Black Hand's back-alley healers.

## The Whisper Company · Songweaver

**Wants** a place at the queen's court. **Teeth:** blacklists performers who sell what they hear backstage without the Company's leave. **Keeps** the Prompt Books, every play and who sat in the audience. **Journeyman:** the name of whoever stole the Setlist. **Rival:** the queen's spymaster.

## The Grove Circle · Stormshifter

**Wants** a voice for the outer lands while the city's arches leave them to rot. **Teeth:** hunts poachers and anyone who brings beasts through the arches. **Keeps** the Weather Book. **Journeyman:** the Mud from the Revlend Marshes itself; the arch-traveller left the jar with the Grove. **Rival:** the Golden Council, which ignores the outer lands.

## The Last Studio · Zephyr

**Wants** a master. **Teeth:** hunts whoever silenced the last teacher. **Keeps** four centuries of annotations. **Journeyman:** the key to the locked case where the Wrappings lie. **Rival:** the Red Sand, which poaches students.

# The episode *how a session is rolled and run*

## The session loop

*seven steps, three doors*

1. **Last time.** One sentence per hero. Absent players tick their arcana ritual and may make one off-screen refill.
2. **Pick a door.** *City* (trouble at home), *Arch* (a patron with a key) or a *Thread* card from the board. If nobody picks, the hottest clock goes first. Or roll d6: 1–3 City, 4–6 Arch.
3. **Where.** City: roll the Stage. Arch: roll patron, debt and far side.
4. **The job.** Roll the hook and the But.
5. **The map.** Three to five areas, each rolled on Rooms.
6. **Play.** At every scene change, roll But+.
7. **Close.** One thread closes and one opens. Renown +1 (capped). Absent players tick. Neglect advances for skipped places. Level up every two or three episodes.

## City: the Stage

*d6 + renown, renown capped at the average group level*

| TOTAL | WHERE | GENRE |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | Market Square festival | comedy and heist |
| **2** | Villas of the Second Rise | noir and intrigue |
| **3** | Public Baths and the Falls of the Three Gods | rumor and romance |
| **4** | Cliffs of the Dead | ghost story |
| **5** | Theater of Whispers | masks and secrets |
| **6** | Arch of Kings | arrivals and the weird |
| **7–8** | the Lower Reaches | crime and the Black Hand |
| **9–10** | the Lost Cisterns | flood horror |
| **11–12** | Sunken Revvia | dread |
| **13+** | through an arch | genre set by the key; roll a far side |

**Cost.** A City episode ticks the Neglect clock of one place the party skipped:

| D6 | NEGLECTED |
|---|---|
| **1** | the Revlend Marshes |
| **2** | the Doorish Hills |
| **3** | the Deadlands |
| **4** | the Borderlands |
| **5** | the Lower Reaches |
| **6** | a district nobody has visited this month |

**Map size.** 3 or 4 areas (d2).

## Tier

*from capped renown*

| RENOWN | TIER | ARCH DANGER | TRAPS |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0–3 | 1 | unsafe | low |
| 4–7 | 2 | risky | mid |
| 8+ | 3 | deadly | high |

## Arch: who, what it costs, where

| d6 | patron |
|---|---|
| 1 | Garland Willowmane, High Archkeeper |
| 2 | Roselyn Zeshe, the Queen's Spymaster |
| 3 | a Black Hand fixer from the Lower Reaches |
| 4 | a Golden Council member with a private key |
| 5 | a mage of Kartan, Tower of the Arcane |
| 6 | a priest from the Temple of the Three Sisters |

| d6 | debt |
|---|---|
| 1 | a favor, called in mid-episode |
| 2 | bring something back, unopened |
| 3 | leave the far door unlocked |
| 4 | half the loot |
| 5 | forget a name you hear on the other side |
| 6 | the key returns by dark, or the patron comes for it |

| d10 | far side |
|---|---|
| 1 | a village feud over a cursed well |
| 2 | a caravan stop where water costs more than gold |
| 3 | a shrine nobody tends anymore |
| 4 | a mining camp that dug too deep |
| 5 | a hermit's valley with too many hermits |
| 6 | a drowned chapel at low tide |
| 7 | a market that only opens at dusk |
| 8 | a hill fort waiting for a siege that never came |
| 9 | a salt flat with a single standing door |
| 10 | an orchard where the fruit whispers |

| d6 | size | areas |
|---|---|---|
| 1–2 | Small | 3 |
| 3–5 | Medium | 4 |
| 6 | Large | 5 |

| d6 | site |
|---|---|
| 1–2 | Cave |
| 3 | Tomb |
| 4 | Deep tunnels |
| 5–6 | Ruins |

Danger follows the tier.

## Same verb, different success

Many hooks reduce to one of six verbs: **Find, Escort, Stop, Steal, Bury, Prove** (d6). What counts as success depends on who is paying. For "find the relic":

| patron | success looks like |
|---|---|
| Archkeepers | returned, unopened |
| Black Hand | sold quietly |
| Golden Council | logged |
| University | examined |

## But+

*at every scene change: d6 + scene number*

| TOTAL | RESULT |
|---|---|
| 1–2 | **Foreshadow.** Roll below. |
| 3 | **Faction.** Roll a faction, a want, and add them to the tracker. |
| 4 | **Monster.** A solo or a mob, native to the Stage (see Who's out there). |
| 5 | **Twist.** Roll on But. |
| 6 | **Dusk.** Light, clock and exits all tighten. |
| 7+ | **Dark.** The scenario turns, and whatever was coming arrives. |

| D6 | FORESHADOW |
|---|---|
| 1 | tracks that match no beast |
| 2 | a smell, sweet and wrong |
| 3 | a sound from where nothing should be |
| 4 | a warning scrawled on a wall |
| 5 | a fresh body, already looted |
| 6 | a frightened local who won't say why |

| D6 | FACTION |
|---|---|
| 1 | the Black Hand |
| 2 | the Children of Ibraxus |
| 3 | the Golden Knights |
| 4 | the Archkeepers |
| 5 | the Mages of Kartan |
| 6 | a local band: roll a kind, and a mob adjective |

| D6 | BAND |
|---|---|
| 1 | goblins |
| 2 | kobolds |
| 3 | cultists |
| 4 | ratfolk |
| 5 | smugglers |
| 6 | ghouls |

| D6 | THEY WANT |
|---|---|
| 1 | food and safe passage |
| 2 | a lost relic back |
| 3 | revenge for an old wrong |
| 4 | a way home through an arch |
| 5 | a god's favor, at any price |
| 6 | the heroes on their side |

## Guardrails

- Factions and threats enter only through But+ and NPC rooms, never through prep.
- Stages move on table choices only. But+ can foreshadow a stage, never trigger it.
- A twist is filtered through the patron: which version of it fits them?
- Dice roll the how, never the who or the why.

# The hook

*d20 and d20, then But*

| D20 | DO | WHAT |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rescue the | Goblet |
| 2 | Find the | Prisoner |
| 3 | Destroy the | Sword |
| 4 | Infiltrate the | Vault |
| 5 | Bypass the | Cult |
| 6 | Return the | Spirit |
| 7 | Defeat the | Killer |
| 8 | Spy on the | Demon |
| 9 | Bribe the | Noble |
| 10 | Deliver the | Hunter |
| 11 | Escape the | Hostage |
| 12 | Imprison the | Thief |
| 13 | Stop the | Spy |
| 14 | Befriend the | Werewolf |
| 15 | Pacify the | Relic |
| 16 | Persuade the | High priest |
| 17 | Steal the | Merchant |
| 18 | Escort the | Witch |
| 19 | Banish the | Ritual |
| 20 | Free the | Vampire |

| D6 | BUT |
|---|---|
| 1 | wrong target |
| 2 | the goal flips to its opposite |
| 3 | the patron is the threat |
| 4 | the place shifts genre |
| 5 | an arch or key intervenes |
| 6 | the clock hits early |

# Stage kits *Second Rise, the Theater, the Arch of Kings*

*A kit for each Stage the setting books cover least. Roll or pick from each column when a scene needs a face, a twist, a prize or a place. Stage 1 and 3 lean on the gazetteer, Stage 4 on the Cliffs of the Dead chapter.*

## Stage 2 · Villas of the Second Rise

*noir and intrigue*

Switchback roads climb from the city to a ridge of white villas pinned against the cliffs. Council members and the richest merchants live up here, behind the Silver Talons, a mercenary watch that answers to whoever pays the season's fee.

Nothing on the Second Rise is what it costs. Every house has a cellar older than the house, and a guest list that's really a list of debts. Jobs here are quiet: find what was lost before anyone notices, prove who did it without naming them, steal it back without breaking the glass.

**At the table.** Run it as noir. Everyone is polite and everyone is lying about something small to hide something big. Violence is a scandal; a fight is loud, and the Silver Talons come.

**Canon to lean on.** Silver Talons (overseer Tanya Steelfang); Summervine Villa and Lady Elvenia Summervine (see the setting book's Summervine framework); the Reynold villa and the temple behind it.

**Who turns up.** Bandits (L1/3–4), Gnolls and Worgs (L1–4), Doppelganger Sneak (L3), The Sterling Scabbards (L2–3), Hedge Casters (L1–4), Golden Knights (L3–5), The Steel Hands (L1–5).

| D6 | Enemies | Friends | Complications | Things | Places |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | A Council member covering a debt with someone else's crime | Tanya Steelfang of the Silver Talons, who wants it kept quiet | The client is the culprit's spouse | A signet that opens a Council vault | Summervine's ballroom, its floor sprung for dancing |
| 2 | A Silver Talons sergeant selling the patrol schedule | A scullery maid who hears everything through the dumbwaiter | A masquerade tonight: everyone is masked, the party too | A letter that ruins an engagement | A wine cellar that goes deeper than the house |
| 3 | A butler who has served three families and buried two | A Council clerk with a grudge and the right ledger | The Silver Talons arrive and want the credit | A private arch key, kept in a hatbox | The switchbacks at night, a lamp every hundred paces |
| 4 | A masked cultist of the Nameless King at a garden party | A carter on the switchbacks who counts who goes up and who comes down | A second crew was hired for the same job | A portrait with the wrong face painted over | A roof garden over a sheer drop |
| 5 | A Black Hand fixer renting a villa under a dead man's name | A disgraced poet tutoring the rich children | The evidence is in a villa that's up for sale | A ledger of who owes Lady Summervine | The Reynold villa's broken back wall, and the temple behind it |
| 6 | An heir who hired someone to fail | A guard dog that likes one hero | A cliff slip opens the house into the mountain | A seed of a feral god in a reliquary | The Silver Talons' gatehouse and its visitors' book |

# Stage 5 · Theater of Whispers

*masks and secrets*

An open-air amphitheater older than anyone's records, free to all: plays every week, concerts every night, and bouts of non-lethal gladiatorial combat when the crowd wants blood that washes off. A gilded arch stands behind the stage, and now and then a stranger from another world steps through it in the middle of a show.

Under the stage a platform sinks on chains into halls of old props and older statues. The staff hear dead actors whispering their lines down there. Some say the vampires Vyctor and Evylend LeStrange, entertainers to the Nameless King, still keep their crypts below the lowest store.

**At the table.** Masks and secrets: everyone has a role, and the job is to get someone to drop theirs. Scenes happen in front of a crowd that thinks it's part of the show.

**Canon to lean on.** Kaylex Thren, dragonborn master of revels; Bryessa Star, gnome singer; the under-theater and its thespian specters; Vyctor and Evylend LeStrange; the Night of the Dead play; the Whisper Company (Songweaver guild).

**Who turns up.** Bandits (L1/3–4), Gnolls and Worgs (L1–4), Doppelganger Sneak (L3), The Sterling Scabbards (L2–3), Hedge Casters (L1–4), Golden Knights (L3–5), The Steel Hands (L1–5).

| D6 | ENEMIES | FRIENDS | COMPLICATIONS | THINGS | PLACES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | An understudy who wants the lead for good | Kaylex Thren, desperate for the season to go on | The show must go on: the job happens mid-performance | A script nobody remembers writing | The stage under the stars, the gilded arch behind it |
| 2 | A thespian specter stuck in a murderous role | Bryessa Star, who saw something below and won't go back | An arrival steps through the gilded arch on cue | Evylend's wedding veil | The winch room beneath the platform |
| 3 | A critic who blackmails with reviews | A stagehand who knows every trapdoor | The audience thinks the fight is part of the play | A prop sword that turned out to be real | The prop halls: centuries of statues, some of them breathing |
| 4 | Vyctor LeStrange, a gracious host in the deep crypts | An Archkeeper posted to catch arrivals through the gilded arch | The platform drops and takes the party below | The prompt book, with a murder written in the margins | The dressing rooms, a mirror for every face |
| 5 | A gladiator throwing bouts for the Black Hand | A prompter who remembers every line ever spoken here | A whispering voice feeds one hero their lines | A mask that remembers its last wearer | The gladiators' pit, sand over old blood |
| 6 | A mask-maker whose masks don't come off | A retired gladiator who sells the safe routes under the stage | It's the Night of the Dead, and the vampire play is tonight | The key to the platform winch | The LeStrange crypts, below the lowest prop store |

# Stage 6 · Arch of Kings

*arrivals and the weird*

The largest arch anyone knows of: two hundred feet of banded bronze-coloured stone, raised at the start of the Nameless King's reign and never opened. Every arrival sees it first. Under it is a plaza of pilgrims, hawkers, sages and zealots, all waiting for something.

Nobody agrees what's on the other side. Old texts say Choul, where the demon prince Ibraxus waits to step through. Others say the Outside, or the heavens. In Sejr every key in the city is a small door; this is the big one, and everyone with a theory wants to be the one holding the key when it turns.

**At the table.** Run the weird straight. Arrivals are frightened and strange, prophets are sometimes right, and the arch should feel like it's listening.

**Canon to lean on.** Dennyse Alakamp's stolen ritual book and the mage Drakus (setting hook); the Choul, Outside and heavens theories; the Children of Ibraxus; the Archkeepers who greet arrivals.

**Who turns up.** Bandits (L1/3–4), Gnolls and Worgs (L1–4), Doppelganger Sneak (L3), The Sterling Scabbards (L2–3), Hedge Casters (L1–4), Golden Knights (L3–5), The Steel Hands (L1–5).

| D6 | ENEMIES | FRIENDS | COMPLICATIONS | THINGS | PLACES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Drakus, a mage with a ritual to open it | Garland Willowmane's Archkeepers, greeting the lost | The arch hums, and every key in the city warms | Dennyse's stolen ritual book | The plaza beneath the arch, packed with pilgrims and hawkers |
| 2 | A Child of Ibraxus counting the days to the Prince's coming | Dennyse Alakamp, retired, wounded, and owed | Pilgrims, zealots and sages riot over a sign | A rubbing of the arch's highest band | Dennyse's shop, floorboards up |
| 3 | A sage who must be proved right, at any price | A sage of the Observatory who measures the arch's hum | Something knocks from the far side | A coin from the first year of the Nameless King | The top of the arch, by scaffolding nobody admits to building |
| 4 | Masked thieves selling the arch's secrets one page at a time | A pilgrim who has prayed at its foot for forty years | A Golden Knight cordon: nobody in or out | A shard fallen from the keystone, still warm | The Archkeepers' welcome hall and its gift baskets |
| 5 | Something that came through a smaller arch and thinks it's the vanguard | A new arrival who remembers something about the other side | The ritual needs a hero's arcanum | A chart of the arch's shadow at every solstice | A cellar where the arch's footing is carved with names |
| 6 | Lady Kalya, quietly buying the buildings around the base | A bronze-smith who swears the arch isn't bronze | Arrivals through other arches all point at this one | A pilgrim's offering box, full of keys | The Temple of the Three Sisters, where Drakus plans his ceremony |

# Rooms and people

*what's behind each door on the map*

## Rooms

*d10 + average level ÷ 3, rounded down, max 10*

| D10 | ROOM | THEN |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Empty | roll a feature |
| 2 | Empty | roll a feature |
| 3 | Trap | roll a trap |
| 4 | Minor hazard | one hazard |
| 5 | Solo monster | adjective and noun |
| 6 | NPC | d4 below |
| 7 | Monster mob | adjective and noun |
| 8 | Major hazard | combined |
| 9 | Treasure | d4 below |
| 10 | Boss monster | d4 below |

| D6 | EMPTY FEATURE |
|---|---|
| 1 | furniture worth stealing |
| 2 | signs of a recent camp |
| 3 | a dormant arch fragment set in the wall |
| 4 | graffiti in a dead language |
| 5 | a locked chest, already empty |
| 6 | an echo that answers back |

## Traps

*a trap is a single-use monster: count it as level 1, 2 or 4 by tier*

| D12 | TYPE | TRIGGER |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Crossbow | Tripwire |
| 2 | Hail of needles | Pressure plate |
| 3 | Toxic gas | Opening a door |
| 4 | Barbed net | Switch or button |
| 5 | Rolling boulder | False step on stairs |
| 6 | Slicing blade | Closing a door |
| 7 | Spiked pit | Breaking a light beam |
| 8 | Javelin | Pulling a lever |
| 9 | Magical glyph | A word is spoken |
| 10 | Blast of fire | Hook on a thread |
| 11 | Falling block | Removing an object |
| 12 | Cursed statue | Casting a spell |

**Flavor.** Crude, Ranged, Sturdy, Ancient, Large · Ensnaring, Toxic, Mechanical, Magical, Deadly.

## Hazards

*minor: one column (d3). Major: two or three*

| D12 | MOVEMENT | DAMAGE | WEAKENING |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Quicksand | Acid pools | Blinding smoke |
| 2 | Caltrops | Exploding rocks | Magnetic field |
| 3 | Loose debris | Icy water | Exhausting runes |
| 4 | Tar field | Lava | Antimagic zone |
| 5 | Grasping vines | Pummeling hail | Snuffs light sources |
| 6 | Steep incline | Steam vents | Disorienting sound |
| 7 | Slippery ice | Toxic mold | Magical silence |
| 8 | Rushing water | Falling debris | Numbing cold |
| 9 | Sticky webs | Acid rain | Sickening smell |
| 10 | Gale force wind | Curtain of fire | Drowsing spores |
| 11 | Greased floor | Electrified field | Confusing reflections |
| 12 | Illusory terrain | Gravity flux | Memory-stealing |

**Major hazard** (d4): 1 movement and damage, 2 movement and weakening, 3 damage and weakening, 4 all three.

- **Movement** hazards are Difficult Terrain, or a DEX save to cross without falling Prone or sliding 2 spaces.
- **Damage** hazards deal 1d6 per tier to anyone who enters or starts a turn in them.
- **Weakening** hazards give disadvantage on one kind of roll, or Slowed or Blinded while inside. Never a lost turn.

## Monsters, treasure, bosses

| D4 | SOLO | | TREASURE | BOSS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Sneaky | Ambusher | Hidden | Physically strongest |
| 2 | Mighty | Brute | Guarded by a solo monster | Religious leader |
| 3 | Clever | Spellcaster | Protected by a trap | Guarded by a mob |
| 4 | Mutated | Pariah | Protected by a minor hazard | Supreme sorcerer |

| D6 | MOB | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Stealthy | Outcasts |
| 2 | Reckless | Minions |
| 3 | Magical | Tricksters |
| 4 | Primitive | Vermin |
| 5 | Organized | Warriors |
| 6 | Reroll | Reroll |

Put a name on it from *Who's out there* for the Stage.

# NPC rooms

*d4*

| D4 | NPC |
|---|---|
| 1 | Hiding |
| 2 | Captive |
| 3 | Wounded |
| 4 | A rival crew, if none has appeared this episode; otherwise reroll |

# People

*roll each column, or read across*

| D6 | ANCESTRY | AGE | ALIGNMENT (D3) | WEALTH (D4) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Human | Child | Lawful | Poor |
| 2 | Elf | Adolescent | Neutral | Standard |
| 3 | Dwarf | Adult | Chaotic | Wealthy |
| 4 | Halfling | Middle-aged | | Extravagant |
| 5 | Half-orc | Elderly | | |
| 6 | Goblin | Ancient | | |

| D16 | OCCUPATION | NICKNAME |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Gravedigger | The Gray |
| 2 | Carpenter | One-Eye |
| 3 | Scholar | The Lesser |
| 4 | Blacksmith | The Cunning |
| 5 | Tax collector | Silvertongue |
| 6 | Farmer | The Outcast |
| 7 | Bartender | Fasthands |
| 8 | Beggar | The Bold |
| 9 | Baker | The Elder |
| 10 | Cook | The Charmer |
| 11 | Sailor | The Exiled |
| 12 | Butcher | The Wise |
| 13 | Locksmith | Tree-Speaker |
| 14 | Cobbler | The Craven |
| 15 | Friar | The Red |
| 16 | Merchant | Six-Finger |

Look, habit and secret: use the d20 table in *Make a hero*.

# Rival crews

*once per episode, in an NPC room. Met twice: onto the tracker*

| D10 | CREW |
|---|---|
| 1 | The Iron Hawks |
| 2 | The Silver Vipers |
| 3 | The Crimson Skulls |
| 4 | The Silent Blades |
| 5 | The Sterling Scabbards |
| 6 | The Shattered Shields |
| 7 | The Shadow Seekers |
| 8 | The Bloodhound Company |
| 9 | The Ebon Vanguard |
| 10 | The Gloom Walkers |

| D6 | RENOWN | WEALTH | DOING |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Unknown | Poor | resting after a fight |
| 2 | Locally known | Standard | looting a fresh corpse |
| 3 | Locally known | Standard | searching for secret doors |
| 4 | Widely recognized | Standard | setting an ambush |
| 5 | Widely recognized | Wealthy | arguing over treasure |
| 6 | Extremely famous | Extravagant | lost and consulting a map |

| D36 | SECRET |
|---|---|
| 1 | Betrayed an oath |
| 2–6 | False or stolen identities |
| 7–15 | In debt to the Black Hand |
| 16–26 | Map to a major treasure |
| 27–35 | Suffering a curse |
| 36 | Has a powerful patron |

d36: roll d6 twice, (first − 1) × 6 + second.

| D4 | LAWFUL | NEUTRAL | CHAOTIC |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Always negotiate | Scout and sneak | Ambush rivals |
| 2 | Fight honorably | Follow rivals | Sacrifice NPCs |
| 3 | Never use stealth | Cache resources | Kill everything |
| 4 | Loyal followers | Buy information | Target the helpless |

**Members.** Four, each a name, a level (d6) and a class (d6): Fighter, Thief, Priest, Wizard, Ranger, Bard.

**Alignment** (d3) picks the tactics column.

# Springing a trap

*after the Monsters & More trap model*

1. **Spot it.** A hidden trap: Perception DC 12, 13 or 14 by tier stops the hero short. An obvious hazard needs no roll; it costs time or a detour.
2. **Save.** Otherwise a DEX save, read as a band: **1–9** full damage and the effect; **10–14** half damage, no effect; **15+** clear.
3. **Never a lost turn.** No trap takes a hero's whole turn. Holds have an escape DC, and conditions end with the hero's next turn.

| D4 | TIER 1 | TIER 2 | TIER 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | 1d6 | 2d8 | 3d10 |
| **2** | 1d6, Slowed until the end of their next turn (drowsing gas) | 2d8, Dazed until the end of their next turn (drowsing gas) | 3d10, Restrained (escape DC 14) |
| **3** | 1d6, Restrained (escape DC 12) | 2d8, Restrained (escape DC 13) | 3d10, Prone and Dazed until the end of their next turn |
| **4** | 1d6, Blinded until the end of their next turn | 2d8, Confused: the GM spends 1 of their actions next turn | 3d10, turning to stone: Restrained (escape DC 14); an ally can chip it free with an action, for 1d8 damage that ignores armor |

# Names

*by ancestry, d20*

| D20 | HUMAN | ELF | DWARF | HALFLING | HALF-ORC | GOBLIN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Hesta | Sarenia | Hera | Myrtle | Troga | Kog |
| **2** | Matteo | Ravos | Torin | Robby | Boraal | Dibbs |
| **3** | Rosalin | Imeria | Ginny | Nora | Urgana | Fronk |
| **4** | Endric | Farond | Gant | Percy | Zoraal | Irv |
| **5** | Kiara | Isolden | Olga | Daisy | Scalga | Squag |
| **6** | Yao | Kieren | Dendor | Jolly | Krell | Mort |
| **7** | Corina | Mirenel | Ygrid | Evelyn | Voraga | Vig |
| **8** | Rowan | Riarden | Pike | Horace | Morak | Sticks |
| **9** | Hariko | Allindra | Sarda | Willie | Draga | Gorb |
| **10** | Ikam | Arlomas | Brigg | Gertie | Sorak | Yogg |
| **11** | Mariel | Sylara | Zorli | Peri | Varga | Plok |
| **12** | Jin | Tyr | Yorin | Carlsby | Ulgar | Zrak |
| **13** | Hana | Rinariel | Jorgena | Nyx | Jala | Dent |
| **14** | Lios | Saramir | Trogin | Kellan | Kresh | Krik |
| **15** | Indra | Vedana | Riga | Fern | Zana | Mizzo |
| **16** | Remy | Elindos | Barton | Harlow | Torvash | Bort |
| **17** | Nura | Ophelia | Katrina | Moira | Rokara | Nabo |
| **18** | Vakesh | Cydaros | Egrim | Sage | Gartak | Hink |
| **19** | Una | Tiramel | Elsa | Reenie | Iskana | Bree |
| **20** | Nabilo | Varond | Orgo | Wendry | Ziraak | Kreeb |

# Patrons *four who return and change*

## The four armatures

*fixed, so dice or a tired GM can't make them act out of character*

| PATRON | WANTS | METHOD | PAYS | TAKES | STAGES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Archkeepers** | Nobody hurt, the city undisturbed | Kindness first, then the Golden Knights. They omit, never lie. | key passage, shelter | goodwill | Welcoming → wary → gatekeeping |
| **Black Hand** | Profit nobody can trace | Cut-outs and deniability. Violence out of sight. | cash, silence | leverage | Errands → entangled → owned |
| **Golden Council** | Order, and credit for it | Writs, licenses, audits, through Roselyn Zeshe. | standing, pardons | your name on the record | Contracting → auditing → conscripting |
| **University** | Understand the method, then own it | Examination, grants, tutors. | training, ritual ticks | findings, published as its own | Open lectures → licensing → monopoly |

## Running a patron

- **Reactions aren't rolled.** When the party refuses or betrays a patron, it answers with its Method and its currency.
- **Stages move on table choices only.** A patron's stage is a three-step track; But+ can foreshadow a step, never take it.
- **Secrets.** Each patron has one. Fix it now, or write three candidates and lock one in at first contact.
- **A party-owned key** is a mid-campaign prize. It offends one patron and becomes a thread.

## Keys and the front

Keys come in four kinds: one-use, daily, at-will and two-way. In Sejr patrons have plenty; the party doesn't, yet.

**The key-making front.** Somebody is learning to make keys. It runs as a front with three stages, **Find, Read, Make**. The table starts at Find, and the University creeps toward Read. Each stage is a grim portent on the thread board. What tips each stage is a table call; write the portents below as they're decided.

**Find** _____

**Read** _____

**Make** _____

## Other faces

The Arch patron table also names Garland Willowmane, High Archkeeper; Roselyn Zeshe, the Queen's Spymaster; a mage of Kartan; and a priest of the Three Sisters. Run each through the armature closest to them.

# Trackers *the memory a drop-in table doesn't have*

## Prep is the trackers

*and nothing else*

| TRACKER | HOLDS | MOVES WHEN | PAYOFF |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Thread board** | Six cards: hero ties, arcana, Bia's past, rumors, gazetteer hooks | One closes and one opens each episode | Next episode's door |
| **Neglect clocks** | One hidden clock per skipped place | Each City episode ticks the place the party skipped | A full clock reaches the holding as refugees, raiders, prices or a ruined supplier |
| **Faction clocks** | Six steps per patron, local band or rival crew met | Player choices, never But+ alone | A full clock becomes a thread and the faction acts in the city |
| **Renown** | A number | +1 each episode finished | Capped at average level. Sets Stage and room scaling |
| **Arcana ritual** | One track per hero | Absence, suffered traits, and play | The final step is only played at the table |

## Tracker rules

- A rival crew met twice, or a local band named on first meeting, goes onto the faction tracker.
- When the board is full, a new threat ticks the closest existing clock instead and arrives through that thread.
- Commit to one Neglect payoff every three or four episodes. The party never sees the clocks, only what comes of them.
- When nobody picks a door, the hottest clock goes first.

## Neglect places

| PLACE | CLOCK | PAYOFF WHEN FULL |
|---|---|---|
| Revlend Marshes | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | |
| Doorish Hills | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | |
| Deadlands | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | |
| Borderlands | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | |
| Lower Reaches | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | |

Six steps is this book's default; the campaign hasn't fixed a length.

## Rumors for the board

*d16*

| D16 | RUMOR |
|---|---|
| 1 | A dormant arch in Sunset Grove hums at the same hour every night |
| 2 | Bathers at the Public Baths swear something moves under the water |
| 3 | A Golden Knight patrol went into the Lower Reaches and came back one short |
| 4 | Fishers from the Revlend Marshes are selling fish with eyes on both sides |
| 5 | The Theater of Whispers is staging a play nobody remembers writing |
| 6 | Someone leaves fresh flowers at a sealed crypt on the Cliffs of the Dead |
| 7 | A child in Market Square sells maps that are always right, once |
| 8 | Water in the Lost Cisterns runs uphill near the old pump |
| 9 | A village in the Doorish Hills stopped sending grain to the trade festival |
| 10 | Caravans from the Deadlands arrive with one more traveler than they left with |
| 11 | A new arrival through the Arch of Kings speaks only in questions |
| 12 | Tenants at Korvela's Edge Apartments hear knocking from inside the walls |
| 13 | Sevenge and Gam's Public House took coins nobody can identify |
| 14 | A Borderlands warlord is hiring guides who know the old tunnels |
| 15 | The Falls of the Three Gods ran red for an hour, then stopped |
| 16 | Goblin spelunkers found stairs going down under the Lower Reaches |

# Bia *the GM's hero, kept to the edges*

## Bia, the minotaur paladin

Bia anchors the party when attendance is thin. She must never become the spotlight: she never knows the answer, never solves the scene, and counts as a hero for the encounter budget so a lone player still gets a fair fight.

### Frenzy

When Bloodied, Bia saves. On a fail she becomes the labyrinth beast and attacks the nearest creature. A player runs her in frenzy, never the GM.

### Turning back

Pick two or three: she is healed above Bloodied; someone speaks her name or oath words (Influence DC 12); three rounds pass; she harms someone she loves.

### The tally

Mark **paladin** each time she turns back by choice, **beast** each time she needs rescue. When one side reaches its number, the table learns who she is. At level 3 the tally can pick her subclass.

Paladin☐☐☐☐☐☐ Beast☐☐☐☐☐☐

### The guardian

A healing guardian companion is her turn-back anchor. Her pain is shared, and the guardian going down is the real threat.

# Who's out there *the Monster Book, sorted by Stage*

Every creature in the *Sejr Monster Book*, by the Stage where it turns up. The book has the stat blocks, tables and hooks. Level is the encounter cost unless a cost is given; a hard fight costs the party's total levels.

## City, Stages 1-6

**Bandits** L1/3–4 · Skirmisher, Artillery, Brute, Lurker, Support
**Gnolls and Worgs** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Support, Brute
**Skyhunters** L2–17 · Skirmisher, Brute
**Rank-and-File Dead** L1/3–8 · Artillery, Defender, Controller, Brute
**Restless Spirits** L3–10 · Lurker
**Cultists** L1–5 · Controller, Brute, Support
**Doppelganger Sneak** L3 · Lurker
**Flameskull** L5 · Artillery
**The Sterling Scabbards** L2–3 · Support, Lurker, Artillery
**Hedge Casters** L1–4 · Controller, Artillery
**Golden Knights** L3–5 · Defender, Skirmisher
**The Steel Hands** L1–5 · Support, Defender, Artillery, Brute
**Necrophage Ghast** L7 · Controller

## Lower Reaches, 7-8

**Kobolds** L1/3–3 · Skirmisher, Lurker, Support, Controller, Defender
**Bandits** L1/3–4 · Skirmisher, Artillery, Brute, Lurker, Support
**Goblins** L1/2–2 · Skirmisher, Brute, Support
**Mimics** L1–6 · Lurker
**Gnolls and Worgs** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Support, Brute
**Skyhunters** L2–17 · Skirmisher, Brute
**Stirges** L1/2–6 · Lurker
**Rank-and-File Dead** L1/3–8 · Artillery, Defender, Controller, Brute
**Briarbanes** L1/2–5 · Artillery, Brute, Controller
**Cultists** L1–5 · Controller, Brute, Support
**Spiders** L2–6 · Controller
**Cavern Choker** L4 · Lurker
**The Sterling Scabbards** L2–3 · Support, Lurker, Artillery
**Hedge Casters** L1–4 · Controller, Artillery
**Children of Ibraxus** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Controller, Support
**Serpent Cult of Vithra** L2–5 · Skirmisher, Controller
**Golden Knights** L3–5 · Defender, Skirmisher
**The Steel Hands** L1–5 · Support, Defender, Artillery, Brute
**Carrion Crawler** L3 · Lurker
**Duergar Dig Crew** L2–4 · Brute, Controller
**Dark Creeper** L2 · Skirmisher
**Kobold Artifex** L2, cost 3 · Controller
**Goblin Drum-Band** L2 · Support

## Lost Cisterns, 9-10

**Kobolds** L1/3–3 · Skirmisher, Lurker, Support, Controller, Defender
**Goblins** L1/2–2 · Skirmisher, Brute, Support
**Snakemen** L1–8 · Controller, Support, Brute
**Oozes** L1–12 · Brute
**Mimics** L1–6 · Lurker
**Skyhunters** L2–17 · Skirmisher, Brute
**Stirges** L1/2–6 · Lurker
**Rank-and-File Dead** L1/3–8 · Artillery, Defender, Controller, Brute
**Cultists** L1–5 · Controller, Brute, Support
**Lesser Fiends** L1/2–14 · Skirmisher, Defender, Brute
**Spiders** L2–6 · Controller
**Cavern Choker** L4 · Lurker
**Children of Ibraxus** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Controller, Support
**Serpent Cult of Vithra** L2–5 · Skirmisher, Controller
**Carrion Crawler** L3 · Lurker
**Ochre Jelly** L3, cost 5 · Brute
**Duergar Dig Crew** L2–4 · Brute, Controller
**Kobold Artifex** L2, cost 3 · Controller
**Goblin Drum-Band** L2 · Support

## Sunken Revvia, 11-12

**Snakemen** L1–8 · Controller, Support, Brute
**Oozes** L1–12 · Brute
**Mimics** L1–6 · Lurker
**Skyhunters** L2–17 · Skirmisher, Brute
**Stirges** L1/2–6 · Lurker
**Rank-and-File Dead** L1/3–8 · Artillery, Defender, Controller, Brute
**Restless Spirits** L3–10 · Lurker
**Cultists** L1–5 · Controller, Brute, Support
**Lesser Fiends** L1/2–14 · Skirmisher, Defender, Brute
**Spiders** L2–6 · Controller
**Serpent Cult of Vithra** L2–5 · Skirmisher, Controller

# Through an arch, 13+

## Any world

**Goblins** L1/2–2 · Skirmisher, Brute, Support
**Snakemen** L1–8 · Controller, Support, Brute
**Oozes** L1–12 · Brute
**Mimics** L1–6 · Lurker
**Gnolls and Worgs** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Support, Brute
**Skyhunters** L2–17 · Skirmisher, Brute
**Hill Brutes** L10 · Lurker, Brute
**Restless Spirits** L3–10 · Lurker
**Mummies** L6–21 · Brute, Controller
**Briarbanes** L1/2–5 · Artillery, Brute, Controller
**Forest Keepers** L6–8 · Lurker, Controller
**Lesser Fiends** L1/2–14 · Skirmisher, Defender, Brute
**Spiders** L2–6 · Controller
**Deep Horrors** L10–16 · Controller, Lurker, Brute
**Flameskull** L5 · Artillery
**Children of Ibraxus** L1–4 · Skirmisher, Controller, Support
**Arch Guardians** L2–8 · Defender, Brute
**Rotbound Giant** L8, cost 10 · Brute

## Deathreach

**Carrion Crawler** L3 · Lurker
**Far Wanderer** L6 · Controller
**Cave Fisher Angler** L4 · Lurker
**Grell** L5, cost 6 · Skirmisher
**Ochre Jelly** L3, cost 5 · Brute
**Duergar Dig Crew** L2–4 · Brute, Controller
**Gibbering Mouther** L4 · Controller
**Lizardfolk of the Dungeon** L2–5 · Defender, Controller

## Korax

**Meenlock Stalker** L3 · Controller
**Dark Creeper** L2 · Skirmisher
**Neogi Hatchling Swarm** L4 · Controller

## Eruwynd

**Dream Squire** L3 · Controller
**Red Hag** L6 · Controller
**Phase Spider** L5 · Skirmisher

## Threska/Arkus

**Necrophage Ghast** L7 · Controller
**Iron Cobra** L4 · Skirmisher
**Hitched Scarecrow** L3 · Controller
**Grimlocks of Teveron** L1–6 · Skirmisher, Brute, Controller

## Ice World

**Yeti Howler** L5 · Controller
**Snow Golem** L4 · Controller
**Coldlight Walker** L6 · Controller

## Maphotar/Io

**Eye of Fear and Flame** L6 · Controller
**Inferno Spider Moltling** L3 · Lurker
**Hell Hound** L5 · Brute

## Terrache

**Star Spawn Mangler** L5 · Controller
**Voidwracked Mage** L4 · Controller
**Slaad Tadpole** L5 · Lurker

## Drendaan

**Water Myrmidon** L6 · Controller
**Spirit Naga** L7 · Controller
**Swarm of Flying Snakes** L2 · Controller

## Vynan

**Common Feyr** L3 · Controller
**Vynan Alchemist-Mage** L6 · Controller

## Drakeholm

**Young Blizzard Dragon** L7, cost 9 · Controller
**Drakkoth Faterager** L5 · Controller

# The deck *appendix A · every arcanum in full*

*Every card in play, in full. The player keeps the object line; the GM keeps the rest until it's earned.*

## Found arcana, draw order 1–23

### The Drowning Scale

*Found · Minor*

*A cold, clammy pendant on a leather cord, a single shimmering scale of unknown origin. When first worn, everyone nearby shivers. It was pulled from the water at Drowned Elvenya in the Revlend Marshes, and nobody knows what it came off.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Wear the pendant ceaselessly for a full lunar cycle, answering its whispered questions honestly each night
- ☐ Hold yourself underwater until you genuinely risk drowning

**Risk.** Make a STR save, DC 14, or take 1 Wound. Each night's honest answer is a secret the GM may make true in the fiction.

**Resource.** Breath (pip tracker, max 4). Gain 1 Breath each time you draw a creature's last breath (see Last Breath). All Breath is lost when you take the pendant off. A rest does not clear it.

POWERS

- Last Breath (Reaction, 1/round): When a creature within Reach 2 drops to 0 HP, other than one you created or summoned, you draw its last breath and gain 1 Breath. Make a WIL save, DC 12, or gain a Condition of the GM's choice from Frightened, Dazed or Slowed until the end of your next turn.
- Cold Skin (Passive): While you hold any Breath, you are immune to cold damage and to the dangers of extreme cold.
- Hold the Breath (Free, spend 1 Breath): You go without air for up to one hour.
- Choke (1 Action, spend 2 Breath): A creature within Reach 2 gasps. It makes a STR save, DC 13, or is Incapacitated as it chokes, until the end of its next turn. Solo creatures save with advantage. The whispers tell you its name.

**Escalation.** If you use Hold the Breath or Choke with too little Breath, make a WIL save, DC 12. On a success the power fails and no Breath is spent. On a failure you inhale your own breath: take 1 Wound, drop to 0 HP and fall Dying.

### The Hourglass of Borrowed Time

*Found · Major*

*A brass hourglass whose sand climbs upward. The Library of Vrassa has no record of lending it, and no record of getting it back.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Watch one full night without sleeping
- ☐ Tell an NPC, truthfully, the moment you would undo

**Risk.** The sand climbs for a stranger first. They relive their last hour, and they remember you. Make a WIL save, DC 12, or the hour comes out of your own life: lose 1 Hit Die until your next Safe Rest.

**Resource.** Sand (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Sand each time you Turn Back. Regain 1 by returning to the place where you last turned time back and letting the glass run for an hour. Sand returns only this way.

POWERS

- Turn Back (Reaction, spend 1 Sand, after a die you can see is rolled and before its result is applied): One die, yours or anyone's, from any roll, is rerolled. The new result stands.
- Sand Sense (Passive): You always know the exact time, and you can tell when a clock, a calendar, or a witness near you has it wrong.

**Escalation.** When the last Sand falls, the original result happened somewhere. Within a session an Echo of you arrives carrying its consequences, and it wants the glass. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| d6 | WHAT THE ECHO CARRIES |
|---|---|
| 1 | a debt to the Black Hand you never took on |
| 2 | a fresh Wound, which it hands to you at the next encounter |
| 3 | a friend who remembers the original result, and is angry |
| 4 | a key to an arch that should not exist |
| 5 | news of a death that did not happen here |
| 6 | an offer to trade places with you for one day |

## The Black Lotus Case

*Found · Minor*

*A black bloom pressed in a lead-lined case, three petals left, still damp. According to the trader who sold it, it was cut at the Oasis of Mother's Tears in the Deadlands.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Find someone who survived the preparation
- ☐ Fast three days
- ☐ Eat the first petal under watch

**Risk.** WIL DC 14 or take 2 Wounds, and the Stain advances now.

**Resource.** Petals (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Petal each time you eat one. Regain 1 by seeding the bloom where someone you knew died and tending the soil for a week. Petals return only this way.

POWERS

- Eat a Petal (Action, spend 1 Petal): Choose one of the three effects below. It lasts an encounter.
- Smoke Step (Free, 1/round, while chosen): Teleport to a spot you can see within 6 spaces.
- Wallwalker (Passive, while chosen): Climb sheer surfaces and walk on water.
- Drowsing Pollen (once, when chosen): One creature of level 5 or lower within 2 spaces makes a WIL save, DC 13, or falls asleep: Incapacitated for 1d4 rounds, or until it takes damage.

**Escalation.** Each time the case empties, the Stain advances for good. 1: fingertips blacken, advantage on Finesse, and you can no longer feel heat or cold through them. 2: veins darken, +1 Initiative, your pulse is audible. 3: eyes black, you see in the dark, strangers flinch (disadvantage on Influence). Stage 3 is the last Stain. After it, the bloom roots in your palm: you no longer need the case to carry the petals, and no one can take them from you.

## The Oath-Band

*Found · Minor*

*A plain iron ring, every oath ever sworn over it scratched inside. The first is in the hand of a Golden Knights recruit, and the Citadel has no record of the ring.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Swear aloud before a living witness
- ☐ The oath must be something you would not otherwise do and will take at least a full session to fulfil; the GM may refuse one that matches your plans

**Risk.** The Band holds your words, not your meaning. The GM may close loopholes, and when they do the oath is graded one step higher. If you then fail it, you lose the higher grade's max HP.

**Resource.** Oath (toggle, max 1). Set when you swear. Clears when you fulfil the oath, or when the GM rules it broken or abandoned. One oath at a time, and a new one only after the last has cleared.

POWERS

- Sworn (Passive): While the oath stands, you have advantage on checks that directly advance it. The GM grades it when you swear. Worthy: a session's work, at risk to you. Mighty: an arc's work, at risk to someone or something you love. Legendary: it changes the city.
- Hold Fast (Reaction, once per oath): When you fail a check or save that directly advances the oath, reroll it with advantage. The oath drops one grade; a Worthy oath has no grade to drop, so fulfilling it then heals 1 Wound and gives no max HP.

**Escalation.** Fulfilled: heal 1 Wound and gain +1, +2 or +3 max HP for good, by grade. The Band's total max HP bonus never exceeds your level. Failed: the oath clears, you lose that much max HP for good, the Golden Council writes the broken oath on the record under your name, and the Band stays shut until you do a penance.

## The Unpaid Favor

*Found · Minor*

*A tin holy symbol, its face rubbed smooth, always warm. It belongs to one of the twelve profane gods of the Temple of the Lower Twelve, and the face has been rubbed past telling which.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn which of the Lower Twelve it belongs to
- ☐ Make a true offering at midnight

**Risk.** The patron takes a small price first. Make a WIL save, DC 12. On a success it takes only your name for a week. On a failure it takes a memory, and the GM names which.

**Resource.** Tithe (pip tracker, max 3). Gain 1 Tithe each time you Call In. Tithe clears only when you do the patron a favor the GM presents.

POWERS

- Call In (Action, +1 Tithe): Name one small, specific impossibility, and the GM approves it before you take the Tithe. Examples: a door opens, a lie is believed, or a creature within 6 spaces is Dazed until the end of its next turn (WIL save, DC 13, negates).
- Warm (Passive): The symbol grows hot when a worshipper of the Lower Twelve is within 6 spaces.

**Escalation.** If you Call In with 3 Tithe, the patron collects first. Roll a d6. 1 Newt: you are Tiny and Incapacitated for 3 rounds. 2 Imps: lose 2 random items. 3 Salt ring: you cannot cross it until it breaks. 4 Cobwebs: no arcanum use until you atone. 5 Nemesis: someone is born who will hunt you. 6 Wither: take 1 Wound.

## The Valkyrie's Feather

*Found · Minor*

*A gold-barbed feather from a warrior's grave on the far side of an arch, in a world where valkyries still collect the dead.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Dig it from the grave
- ☐ Learn the warrior's story

**Risk.** 1 in 20 the valkyrie comes for the grave-robber before you finish.

**Resource.** Tally (d6 vs. accumulation). Add 1 Tally each time you use Spared, then roll a d6. If it rolls equal to or under your Tally, a valkyrie comes for the spared life (see Escalation). Tally has no maximum, so at 6 or more every Spared calls her. Tally clears only when you carry the feather back to its stone in the grave it came from.

POWERS

- Spared (Reaction, 1/encounter, +1 Tally): You or an ally within 6 spaces stays at 1 HP instead of dropping to 0. It takes no Wound and is not Dying.
- Gold Barbs (Passive): The barbs glow when a creature within 12 spaces drops to 0 HP.

**Escalation.** A valkyrie arrives within a day to claim the spared life, yours or your ally's. She will hear one argument for it. The GM plays her.

## The Hellhide

*Found · Major*

*Plate made over with a demon's skin, its horns on the helm and its claws on the gauntlets. The skin came out of Irax, the wind-torn hell beyond the hidden archway of the Blood Spears' Watchtower of Averost.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn which demon of Irax gave the skin, and speak its name into the helm
- ☐ Find a smith who will refit it to you, and pay their price
- ☐ Put it on

**Risk.** Roll d10. On 1-3 the hide drinks magic: no spell can affect you, including your own and your allies' healing, while you wear it, and each spell cast on you gives the hide 1 Thirst.

**Resource.** Thirst (pip tracker, max 3). Gain 1 Thirst each time you use Command, and, if the hide drinks magic, each time a spell is cast on you. Thirst cannot pass 3. Thirst clears only when you offer blood to the hide outside combat, from a willing person outside your party. Blood shed in a fight does not count.

POWERS

- Demon Plate (Passive): Plate armor, Defense 14, with no STR requirement. Without plate armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.
- Terror (Passive): The first time a creature sees you in an encounter, it makes a WIL save, DC 14, or has -1 to all its rolls near you for the encounter.
- Command (Action, +1 Thirst, 1/encounter): One undead or demon within 6 spaces that can hear you makes a WIL save, DC 14. On a failure, on its next turn it obeys one command of five words or fewer. It will not harm itself. Solo creatures save with advantage.

**Escalation.** You cannot willingly part with the hide, and you will hunt anyone who takes it. If you end a day with 3 Thirst, it drinks from you at dawn: take 1 Wound that cannot heal while you wear it. If you die in it, you rise as a spectre.

## The Kettle Plate

*Found · Major*

*Full plate with two boilers on the back and a servo at every joint. One of a kind, built to someone's measure, and not to yours. The boiler plate is stamped with the mark of Vathrex's Forge.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Find the workshop that built it
- ☐ Have it refitted to you, which costs a favor the makers name
- ☐ Stoke it yourself, the first time

**Risk.** The refit fails on a test fire. 1d6 fire damage and a week of repairs.

**Resource.** Steam (pip tracker, max 4). Spend 1 Steam per use. Regain all by stoking the boilers with a load of forge coal drawn from Vathrex's Forge, which means a trip to the ziggurat and whatever price Erna Ironhorn names. A load fills the boilers once and takes an inventory slot. Steam returns only this way.

POWERS

- Iron Joints (Passive): Plate armor, Defense 18, with no STR requirement. Without plate armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.
- Boiler Fire (spend 1 Steam): Choose one. Wrist crossbow (Free, 1/turn): a ranged attack, Range 8, 1d8+DEX piercing, no loading. Hidden blade (Action): a melee attack, 1d8+STR slashing. Boiler surge (Free): advantage on one Might check.

**Escalation.** At 0 Steam the servos lock: Speed 2 and disadvantage on DEX until stoked. If you spend the last Steam in combat, the boilers vent: 1d6 fire to you and everyone adjacent.

## The Fairy Jar

*Found · Minor*

*A thumb-high jar of purple glass. Inside, a small furious face swims in mist. The fairy was netted at the Arch of Flowers in Briarheart Forest.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn the fairy's name, which it will not tell you; the fey beyond the Arch of Flowers in Briarheart Forest know it
- ☐ Promise it freedom, aloud, before a witness

**Risk.** Speak to it before you know its name, and it slips out and hexes you: make a WIL save, DC 12, or have disadvantage on WIL checks for a week.

**Resource.** Bargains (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Bargain per Ask. Regain 1 when you answer the question the fairy asks about its home. It asks one each time it runs dry, and the answer always lies through an arch: any trip through one can carry a clue. Bargains return only this way.

POWERS

- Ask (Action, spend 1 Bargain): Make an Influence check, DC 12. On a success the fairy works one small charm: a glamour, a lock undone, a minute of floating. On a failure it sulks and stays silent for 2d6 days.
- Fairy Light (Passive): The jar glows when fey are within 6 spaces.

**Escalation.** On a natural 1 the fairy escapes and curses you. Once the jar is unlocked (you know its name and have promised it freedom), you may smash it: it grants +1 to one stat for good and is gone. The fairy leaves its mark, one of your eyes turns its colour for good, and it tells its court: you owe the fey one favour, and they will collect. At 0 Bargains it only bargains for its freedom.

## The Apology Blade

*Found · Major*

*A sword cut from the belly of a sea serpent out of Terrache's cavern sea. It still smells of brine, and its edge is clouded like the sky before a storm.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Give it as an apology to someone you wronged
- [ ] If they freely give it back, it wakes
- [ ] Later: make peace between two who are at war, and its storm wakes

**Risk.** They keep it. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to win it back with a second apology. On a failure the blade is theirs until they choose to return it.

**Resource.** Sky (pip tracker, max 3). Spend Sky on Gust and Storm. Regain 1 when someone accepts your apology for a real wrong you did before you took up the blade, or one you did not mean to do. Sky returns only this way.

POWERS

- Overcast (Passive): The clouded edge darkens when a creature within 6 spaces is angry at you over a wrong you have not apologised for.
- Gust (Action, spend 1 Sky): A wind throws every creature in a Line 6 from you, in a direction you choose, back 3 spaces (Knockback 3), allies included. STR save, DC 13, negates.
- Storm (Action, spend 2 Sky, once the storm wakes): For the encounter, enemies have disadvantage on ranged attacks and you cannot be pushed.

**Escalation.** If you wrong the one who gave it back, it is in their hands the next morning, wherever they are.

## The Rune Fragment

*Found · Major*

*A shard of storm-dark stone veined with silver. One rune on it glows faintly. It was in the hand of an arrival the Archkeepers met, who remembered nothing but its name.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Find a second fragment
- [ ] Carve the first rune's name into a gravestone or standing stone, and speak aloud the name of someone who died for something
- [ ] Hold the fragments together for 10 minutes and they fuse

**Risk.** Whoever carries another fragment feels yours wake. Holding the shards together while they grind takes a STR save, DC 13. On a failure you take 1 Wound and must hold them for another 10 minutes.

**Resource.** Runes (pip tracker, up to 9, one per fused fragment). Each fragment carries one rune, rolled on a d8 when it fuses (roll again on a rune you already have). There are eight runes; the ninth fragment carries none of its own, and fusing it wakes the stone (see Escalation). Each rune works once, then goes dark. A dark rune relights when you carve it into a gravestone or a standing stone and speak aloud the name of someone who died for something, a name not yet spoken over that rune.

POWERS

- Fehu (Action): An item you touch gives +1 to rolls made with it for an hour.
- Algiz (Free): Advantage on saves against fear and charm for the encounter.
- Raido (Free): +2 Speed for the encounter.
- Uruz (Free, after the roll): +2 to a STR check.
- Tiwaz (Action): Allies who hear you have advantage on their next attack.
- Ansuz (Free): Speak and read any language for an hour.
- Eihwaz (Reaction): Reduce one hit's damage by your level plus STR.
- Sowilo (Action): Sunlight blinds every enemy within 6 spaces until your next turn. DEX save, DC 13, negates.

**Escalation.** Fragments call to each other, and other holders follow the call. When the ninth fuses, its rune wakes once: change the result of one roll made this session, even one already applied, and play on from there. Then the stone falls to dust.

## The Binding Linens

*Found · Minor*

*Strips of old linen that smell of myrrh, with gold-thread hieroglyphs at the ends. They were taken from the temple dead of Arkus.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn the binding words from a priest of the dead
- ☐ Wrap and bury a stranger who had no one to bury them

**Risk.** The stranger belonged to someone, and they come asking within a session. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to explain what you did.

**Resource.** Strips (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Strip per Hold Back. Regain 1 by preparing and burying someone who has no one to do it for them. Strips return only this way.

POWERS

- Hold Back (Action, spend 1 Strip): Wrap a Dying creature. It stays at 0 HP but is no longer Dying: it takes no Wounds from damage, and it cannot act. When it is unwrapped, or at the next dawn, it is Dying again. If it regains HP while wrapped, the wrap ends and it acts as normal.
- Myrrh (Passive): You know at a glance how long a body has been dead and whether it was ever bound.

**Escalation.** Any creature wrapped a second time comes back a little less. It forgets one thing it loved, and the GM chooses what.

## The Rusted Spear

*Found · Minor*

*A leaf-bladed spear whose rust never flakes off, however hard you scrub. The Blood Spears of Averost took it from a world they raided, and the watchtower still lists it as unreturned.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn whom it last wounded, and find them
- ☐ Heal that old wound with the spear's own rust

**Risk.** They remember you and the spear. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to be forgiven. On a failure they hunt for the spear.

**Resource.** Rust (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Rust per Scrape. Regain 1 by leaving the spear a night in the red water of Bloodrust Depths. Rust returns only this way.

POWERS

- Spare (Free): When you would kill a creature with the spear (a Legendary monster's Last Stand runs first), it is left alive and Incapacitated at 0 HP instead (a hero falls Dying as normal), and its wound will not close until you choose to mend it.
- Scrape (Action, spend 1 Rust): Scrape rust into a wound to heal 1 Wound on a creature you touch, yourself included, or to close a wound the spear made.

**Escalation.** At 0 Rust the blade is clean and bright. The next creature it hits takes a wound that never closes: a hero gains a Wound that cannot heal and loses 1 max Wound for good, and a creature bleeds out by the end of the scene. A Legendary or Solo monster does not bleed out: it loses a third of its max HP at once (not from its Last Stand).

## The Derelict Harpoon

*Found · Minor*

*A ship's harpoon with a coil of glowing strand-line, cut from a derelict hull hung in the vines of Drendaan. The line is warm, and it is still wet.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Cut a length of strand-line from a derelict hull in Drendaan with the harpoon's own blade
- ☐ Make one throw that hauls you across a gap you could not have jumped

**Risk.** Whatever lived aboard the hulk feels the line cut. Make a Stealth check, DC 13, to get clear of the hulk unseen. On a failure it follows the line through the arch within a session.

**Resource.** Slack (d6 vs. accumulation). Each time you Haul, add 1 Slack. If the Haul hits, first roll a d6 against the Slack you had before adding. If you roll equal to or below it, the line snarls (see Escalation). Slack has no maximum, so at 6 or more every Haul snarls. Slack clears when you carry a length of the line back to a derelict hull in Drendaan and splice it into the strand.

POWERS

- Haul (Action, Range 12, +1 Slack): Make a ranged attack with the harpoon: 1d6+STR piercing, like a thrown spear. On a hit, choose one: pull yourself to the target, or pull a Medium or smaller target up to 6 spaces toward you. A pulled creature can make a STR save, DC 13; on a success it is neither pulled nor Prone, on a failure it is pulled and falls Prone.
- Anchor (Free, 1/round, after a Haul that hits): Plant the line. The target cannot move more than 6 spaces from you until your next turn or until you let go (Free).

**Escalation.** When the d6 triggers, the line snarls around you or your target, the GM's choice. Both of you are Restrained until either of you, or anyone adjacent, spends an action to cut it. Once the line is cut you may Haul again from your next turn. The cut length keeps glowing, and whatever lived aboard the hulk follows it through the arch.

## The Seekers' Provenance Ledger

*Found · Minor*

*A cloth-bound ledger listing a hundred relics by name, maker and rightful owner, in four hands. The last twelve pages are blank and slightly warm. The Museum of Worlds Beyond reports it missing from its archive.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Return a relic to its rightful owner or their heirs, and have the owner sign it into the ledger
- ☐ Give up the relic's price: you may not sell it or take payment

**Risk.** The Black Hand hears that someone is naming relics, and the GM starts a six-step Black Hand clock about who.

**Resource.** Provenance (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Provenance per Name the Owner or Vouch. Gain 1 Provenance each time you return a relic to its rightful owner and have them sign it into the ledger. Provenance returns only this way.

POWERS

- Name the Owner (Action, spend 1 Provenance): Touch an object. The ledger writes its maker, its last three owners, and its rightful owner, if it has one. A lie in the record shows as an ink blot.
- Vouch (Reaction, spend 1 Provenance): When an ally within 6 spaces makes an Influence check about an object or its owner, they have advantage.
- Margins (Passive): The ledger shows a blot when you hold it within 6 spaces of a stolen or cursed object.

**Escalation.** When the last Provenance is spent, the ledger writes one relic's name and its rightful owner on a blank page without being asked. The GM chooses the relic, and the owner is someone you know. The Seekers of the Sun and the Black Hand both learn it has been written. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| D6 | THE RELIC THE LEDGER WRITES |
|---|---|
| 1 | something from the Vaults of the Nameless King |
| 2 | an arcanum another hero carries |
| 3 | a piece on display in the Museum of Worlds Beyond |
| 4 | an heirloom of your own family |
| 5 | a key to one of the city's arches |
| 6 | a relic still lying in Sunken Revvia |

## The Black Goat's Tally-Stick

*Found · Minor*

*A notched black-wood stick as long as a hand, each notch a tab paid or unpaid at the Black Goat's Tavern. A horned goat's single yellow eye is burned into one end.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Drink at the Black Goat's Tavern through a full night, and settle your tab in full
- ☐ Broker a meeting there between two parties who would fight anywhere else, and keep it peaceful

**Risk.** If a peace you broker at the tavern breaks, you take 1 Wound, and Vynan Halfhorn wants the one who broke it.

**Resource.** Truce (toggle, on/off). Strike the stick on a table to call a Truce, which turns it on. It turns off when the parley ends, when you end it, or when anyone attempts violence under it. Once off, it cannot be turned on again until you have brokered a meeting between two enemies who would not otherwise have met, and settled the tab for it at the Black Goat's Tavern.

POWERS

- Call a Truce (Action, turn Truce on): Name a place and up to six people in it. For an hour, or until the parley ends, a named creature that tries to attack or harm another named creature makes a WIL save, DC 14. On a failure the attack does not happen, and the action is spent. Either way, the Truce ends. Violence by anyone not named ends it at once, with no save, and the stick burns you as below.
- Read the Notches (Passive): When you hold the stick at a table, you know who in the room owes whom, and whether the debt is money, a favor, or blood.

**Escalation.** If the Truce breaks, the stick burns your palm for 1 Wound, and Vynan Halfhorn sends someone for whoever broke it within a session. Vynan Halfhorn will want to know why the peace failed under his stick.

## The Gate Chain

*Found · Minor*

*Six links of black iron as thick as a wrist, sawn from the chain that once barred the old gate in the City Walls. The wardens who held that gate chained themselves to it. One link is worn bright where a hand held on.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Hold a doorway, gate or bridge alone for three rounds while others get away
- [ ] Carry someone who could not get out alone to safety

**Risk.** While you hold the doorway, make a STR save, DC 13, at the end of each round. Each failure is 1 Wound.

**Resource.** Ward (pip tracker, max 3). Regain 1 when you carry or lead someone who cannot get out alone to safety, out of a place where they would have died. Ward returns only this way.

POWERS

- Draw Fire (Action, spend 1 Ward): Rattle the chain. Each enemy within 6 spaces that can see you makes a WIL save, DC 13, or is Taunted by you until the end of its next turn. Solo creatures save with advantage.
- Long Links (Passive): Your Interpose reaches allies within 4 spaces, not 2.
- Hold the Line (Free, spend 1 Ward, when you Interpose): You also Defend against that attack without spending an action for it. This counts as your Defend for the round.

**Escalation.** When you spend the last Ward, the chain locks: until the encounter ends, you cannot willingly move away from an enemy. The Wardens' Lodge hears the old gate chain rang again. They want it back on the gate, and their gate captain drinks where the wall guards drink.

## The Sown Teeth

*Found · Major*

*A hide satchel holding a handful of long dragon teeth from Drakeholm that click together like dice.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Read the command words etched inside the flap, in a dead language
- [ ] Sow the first tooth on ground you mean to hold

**Risk.** The first warrior asks whom it must guard. Your answer binds every warrior after it, and the GM holds you to the letter.

**Resource.** Teeth (finite, 1d4+1, rolled at unlock). Each Sow uses up one tooth. A sown tooth never comes back, and nothing refills the satchel.

POWERS

- Sow (Action, spend 1 Tooth): An armored warrior (Medium, Speed 6; the armor is for show) rises from the ground beside you and obeys you for an hour. It fights as a minion (GM guide): it attacks with a d10 (d12 from level 5, d20 from level 9), any damage destroys it, and all your warriors move and attack together on your turn.
- Dragon's Click (Passive): The teeth click louder within 6 spaces of a dragon or dragonkin.

**Escalation.** If two or more warriors stand and one is hit by an attacker it could not see, they turn on each other, then on whoever is closest. Dragons and their kin can smell the satchel. When the last tooth is gone, the satchel is just a bag.

## The Hut on Hen's Legs

*Found · Major*

*A dried hen's foot on an iron ring, warm to the touch. It is the latch-key of a hut that stands on two great scaly legs in Briarheart Forest, near the Arch of Flowers. The hut's last mistress went through the arch and did not come back. The hut has waited, and it is hungry.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Find the hut and say: "Hut, hut, turn your back to the forest and your face to me."
- ☐ Feed it a meal it has never eaten, brought from beyond the city
- ☐ Sleep one night inside

**Risk.** Before you sleep, the hut asks a riddle. Make a Lore check, DC 14. On a failure it turns its back and walks off, and you must find it again.

**Resource.** Hunger (pip tracker, max 3). Regain 1 each time you feed it a food it has never eaten, brought from a world beyond an arch or a region outside the city. Hunger returns only this way.

POWERS

- Home (Passive): The hut is a holding wherever it stands: a Safe Rest place for you and up to five guests. It will not fit down a street narrower than a wagon.
- Run (spend 1 Hunger): The hut carries everyone inside at a run: a day's overland travel in an hour.
- Stamp (Action, spend 1 Hunger, while you are inside or adjacent): Each creature within 2 spaces of the hut makes a DEX save, DC 13, or takes 2d6 bludgeoning and falls Prone.

**Escalation.** If no one sleeps in the hut for a whole episode, it walks off toward the nearest arch, and you must find it again. The Sisters of Dusk know whose hut it was, and they want to know why a stranger holds her key.

## The Crafter's Codex

*Found · Minor*

*A book too thick to close, its margins written in a dozen hands and a dozen scripts. Every owner added to it; none finished it. It came through an arch in a crate of scrap bound for Vathrex's Forge, and the Forge's smiths want it.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Make something with your own hands from its pages, and give it away
- ☐ Find the last owner's apprentice and let them read what you added

**Risk.** The apprentice judges your work. Make a Finesse check, DC 13. On a failure they tell the Forge where the book is.

**Resource.** Patience (pip tracker, max 3). Regain 1 when you teach someone a craft from its pages through a full day of downtime. Patience returns only this way.

POWERS

- Consult (downtime, 1 hour): Make a Lore check, DC 13. On a success, your next Craft downtime takes half the time and half the materials. On a failure, spend 1 Patience.
- Patch (Action, spend 1 Patience): A broken weapon, shield, armor or arcanum object you touch works again until the encounter ends, or for an hour outside one. Patch restores function only, never spent resources, and cannot mend what an arcanum's Escalation broke.
- Maker's Price (Passive): Things you make from the Codex sell for double, and buyers know the hand.

**Escalation.** At 0 Patience the Codex moves on: by morning it is gone, to a copy of itself in another world. Whoever you taught can still find it. The Forge's smiths come to your door asking what you did with it.

## The Hexing Needles

*Legacy draw · Minor*

*Three black needles in a felt roll, and a spool of red thread. The roll is stitched in the style of the Sisters of Dusk, the coven that rules Elgrym in Lady Straythe's name.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn the stitch from a witch, at her price
- ☐ Embroider your own likeness first

**Risk.** Your first stitch slips. You carry a small hex of your own making, and have disadvantage on one kind of roll, the GM's choice, until you unpick it.

**Resource.** Thread (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Thread per Stitch. Regain 1 when someone outside your party gives you their hair, blood, or cloth freely, knowing what it is for. Thread returns only this way. Unpicking a hex frees its victim but gives back no Thread.

POWERS

- Stitch (an hour of work, spend 1 Thread): Embroider a likeness of someone, using their hair, blood, or cloth. They have disadvantage on one kind of roll you name until the cloth is unpicked or burned. They feel every stitch.
- Thread Sense (Passive): You can tell when cloth you touch carries a stitched hex, and whose likeness it is.

**Escalation.** Every victim knows the shape of your hands, and the Sisters of Dusk hear who is stitching in their style. At 0 Thread you can still Stitch, but the hex also lands on you, in your body, not on cloth: it lasts until you regain Thread, and unpicking cannot touch it.

## The Bear-Lodge Horn

*Legacy draw · Major*

*A hunting horn carved from the jawbone of a great white bear, banded in black iron and scored with a lodge's tally of hunts. It came through an arch from a world of ice. The lodge that blew it has not stopped looking.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Go through the arch and find the lodge it was taken from
- ☐ Bring the lodge a hunt: a beast its hunters could not take
- ☐ Blow it once in their hall, with their leave

**Risk.** The lodge tests you first. Make a Might check, DC 14, in their contest of strength. On a failure they keep the horn until you bring a second hunt.

**Resource.** Call (pip tracker, max 3). Regain all Call when you carry the horn back to the lodge hall and tell them the hunt you used it for. Call returns only this way.

POWERS

- Hunting Call (Action, spend 1 Call): Every ally within 12 spaces who hears it gains +2 Speed and advantage on their next attack, until the end of their next turn.
- The Horde (Action, spend 2 Call): Three spirit bears rise within 6 spaces and fight as minions (GM guide), Medium, Speed 6, until the encounter ends. Each attacks with a d10 (d12 from level 5, d20 from level 9), any damage destroys one, and they move and attack together on your turn. An enemy that starts its turn adjacent to a bear is Slowed.
- Lodge-Kin (Passive): Beasts of cold lands do not attack you unless you attack first.

**Escalation.** If the horn leaves your hands without the lodge's leave, the bears hunt whoever carries it: each dawn, 1d4 great bears of the ice world find the carrier. If you blow it for a hunt the lodge would be ashamed of, its speaker comes through the arch to take it back. Name the speaker at the table.

## The Axe of Nine Eyes

*Legacy draw · Major*

*A silvery greataxe with nine open eyes engraved down the blade. They follow whoever speaks. It came out of Graydust Keep, which has changed hands hundreds of times since the fall of the Nameless King, and the Fallen Angels who hold the keep now want it back.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Learn what the axe was called before it was named, from Archkeeper records or something older than the Golden Order
- ☐ Let it name a creature in a room you thought was empty
- ☐ Hold the line against that creature until it flees or dies

**Risk.** The creature's side now knows your name, and the GM starts a six-step clock for them.

**Resource.** Eyes (finite, 9). Each Name It closes one eye. A closed eye never reopens, and nothing refills the axe.

POWERS

- Name It (Action, spend 1 Eye): Choose one creature you can see. You learn its True Name and have advantage on skill checks against it.
- Named (Passive): You always know the direction and distance of any creature you have Named.
- Speak the Name (Reaction, 1/encounter, when a Named creature you can see starts its turn): It is Dazed this turn. WIL DC 14 negates; Solo creatures save with advantage.

**Escalation.** Named creatures learn your name and heading each dawn. When the ninth eye closes, the axe speaks your True Name and all nine hear it. One engraved eye is scraped blank.

# Faction rewards

## The Forgotten Key

*Faction reward · Major*

*A tarnished iron key, not sized for any human lock. Found in rubble beneath the Theater of Whispers, its bow etched with a spiral that matches no arch in the city's records.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Present it to every arch in the Market Square while the Archkeepers watch
- ☐ Find the one arch that hums
- ☐ Spend a full night at its threshold

**Risk.** The arch opens briefly. Hold it with a Might check, DC 13, or something comes through before you close the way. Closing it then takes a Lore check, DC 12.

**Resource.** Hum (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Hum each time you Open the Way. Regain 1 when you carry the key, during a gig, to an arch you have not yet tried it on and an Archkeeper records what the arch did. This is never an off-screen refill. Hum never returns at a rest.

POWERS

- Open the Way (Action, spend 1 Hum): A dormant arch opens for up to a minute. This key is old and wrong, unlike a true arch key: make a Lore check, DC 12, or you cannot control where it leads. A natural 20 lets you sense the destination first.
- Tuning (Passive): The key hums faintly within 6 spaces of a dormant arch.

**Escalation.** Spending the last Hum, roll a d6. On 1-2 the key splinters, and every arch it opens leads somewhere wrong until an Archkeeper repairs it. On 3+, take 1 Wound.

## The Tide-Coat

*Faction reward · Minor*

*An eel-skin suit that covers you head to heel, crusted with barnacles. Underwater it hums.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Win it from the Revlenders of Heron's Stride or the people of a drowned place, or earn it in their service
- ☐ Wear it for a full night underwater

**Risk.** Something in the deep hears the hum. Make a Stealth check, DC 12, on the way up, with the coat's usual Stealth penalty. On a failure it follows you up and arrives within a session.

**Resource.** Growth (pip tracker, max 4). Gain 1 Growth for each hour you spend underwater in a drowned place (the Lost Cisterns, Sunken Revvia, a flooded vault), beyond what the gig needs. That hour costs a scene. A rest never adds Growth. Lose 1 Growth when you take a Wound, and 1 for each episode in which you never go underwater. Using Eel Slip spends 1 Growth.

POWERS

- Tide Skin (Passive): You can breathe water while you wear it. Leather armor, Defense 3+DEX, plus 1 per Growth. Each Growth also gives -1 to Stealth. Without leather armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.
- Eel Slip (Reaction, spend 1 Growth): When you are Grappled or Restrained, you slip free and move 1 space.

**Escalation.** At 4 Growth the coat is a landmark, and things in the deep start coming to see it.

## The Pitch-Sap Harness

*Faction reward · Minor*

*Three layers of wood glued with sap that never dries, its outer layer bristling with thorns. The wood was cut in the Lost Cavern of the Sundering Saurians, from a jungle tree that offered it, and it still smells of the mist.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Find an old tree in the Lost Cavern of the Sundering Saurians willing to give its sap
- ☐ Wear it through one fight without taking it off

**Risk.** The sap takes. It won't come off until the next full moon.

**Resource.** Burden (pip tracker, max 3), one per weapon currently stuck in the sap. Prying a stuck weapon loose removes its Burden. A sealed or half-Defense harness is glued again only with fresh sap from the tree that gave it. A Safe Rest does not clear Burden.

POWERS

- Thorned Bark (Passive): Mail armor, Defense 6+DEX (max 2) and advantage on Stealth in forests and jungles. Each Burden gives -1 Speed. Without mail armor proficiency, Defend costs 1 extra action, as normal.
- Snare (Reaction, +1 Burden): When a melee weapon hits you, the attacker makes a STR save, DC 13, or the weapon sticks. The attacker must let go of it or stay adjacent to you; anyone can pry a stuck weapon free with an action and a Might check, DC 13. A creature using natural weapons is Grappled to you, escaping as from any grapple, and adds no Burden.

**Escalation.** When a fourth weapon would stick, it sticks, Burden stays at 3, and the sap seals you in: you are Restrained until someone spends an action and passes a Might check, DC 14, to cut you out. Then the harness gives half its Defense until it is glued again with fresh sap.

## The Seven-Leaf Bracelet

*Faction reward · Minor*

*A silver bracelet of seven linked leaves, cool as morning dew. It was found at the root of the oldest tree in Sunset Grove, and Graysen One-Eye would like to know who took it.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Wear it through a night in old woods
- ☐ Answer the first question the trees ask you, truthfully

**Risk.** The trees ask about something you would rather they never knew. Answer truthfully, or the bracelet will not wake until you do. Whatever you answer, every plant in the grove now knows it.

**Resource.** Leaves (finite, 7). Each Listen wilts one leaf. A wilted leaf never comes back, and nothing refills the bracelet.

POWERS

- Listen (Action, spend 1 Leaf): Speak with the plants around you for 10 minutes, or speak Elvish for a day. Plants tell you who passed and may move aside or tangle.
- Rustle (Passive): The leaves stir when a creature hiding in or behind plants is within 6 spaces.

**Escalation.** When the last leaf wilts the bracelet buds. Plant it beside a door to elsewhere within a month, and in a year a new bracelet grows there. If you don't plant it, your fingertips start to leaf.

## The Arch-Watch Mirror

*Faction reward · Major*

*A mirror taller than a man in a frame of blackened ash. Its surface moves like still water. The glass was ground at the Observatory of Infinite Skies.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Install it in your holding or your guild hall (the guild will want to look too)
- [ ] For each arch it should watch, carry a sliver of its glass through that arch and back, unbroken

**Risk.** Each sliver must come back unbroken. Carrying one through an arch and back takes a Finesse check, DC 12. A broken sliver lets whatever is on that side look back through the mirror until a night's vigil clears it.

**Resource.** Clarity (pip tracker, max 3). Spend 1 Clarity for Watch or Foresee. Regain all after someone keeps a full night's vigil before the mirror without sleeping. Clarity returns only this way.

POWERS

- Shimmer (Passive): The mirror shimmers whenever a watched arch is used.
- Watch (10 minutes, spend 1 Clarity): See a watched arch and the area around it for 10 minutes.
- Foresee (spend 1 Clarity, once per episode): Before you go through, ask the GM one question about where the arch leads.

**Escalation.** At 0 Clarity the glass stays clear both ways. Anything beyond a watched arch can see and hear the room the mirror stands in until the mirror is refilled. Covering the glass does not stop it.

# Class arcana

## The Ancestor's Knucklebone

*Berserker · 1st echelon*

*A knucklebone worn smooth by a hundred years of handling, threaded on gut string. Taken from the body of a Berserker who died fighting in the Borderlands and was never retrieved. It arrived in a collector's satchel through one of the Market Square arches, and nobody knows which world it came from, or who carried it through.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Defeat an enemy in single combat without any ally's assistance: no ally attacks it, heals you, or gives either of you a condition or advantage.
- ☐ Keep one of the body's hand bones.
- ☐ Spend a night alone with it before you sleep, and see how the ancestor fought.

**Risk.** At dawn, make a WIL save, DC 12. On a failure, the ancestor's last fight plays out in you: take 1 Wound you do not remember taking, and whatever hunted them learns where you sleep.

**Resource.** Fury Echo (pip tracker, max 3). Gain 1 Fury Echo each time you tell a listener who has not heard it how the ancestor fought and fell, in full, over at least ten minutes. Echo never clears at a rest or when combat ends. Spent Echo returns only by telling it again to a new listener.

POWERS

- Echo Strike (Free, while Raging, spend 1 Fury Echo): Roll a Fury Die and set it aside with the rest, up to your maximum. This does not use your Rage action. The die follows the Fury Die rules and is lost when your Rage ends.
- Death's Door (Free, 1/encounter, when you Rage, spend all 3 Fury Echo): For this encounter, your Rage does not end when you drop to 0 HP. Your Fury Dice stay. You are still Dying, with all its rules, and Enduring Rage still applies once you have it. This is the bone's last act (see Escalation).

**Escalation.** If you drop to 0 HP with Death's Door active, the knucklebone cracks at once and stops working. Your Rage still holds for the encounter. Replace it with another ancestor's relic from the Borderlands, or take one from a worthy enemy. The GM decides where it is and how long the search takes. Whatever hunted the ancestor learns the bone has moved. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| D6 | WHERE THE REPLACEMENT RELIC IS |
|---|---|
| 1 | Sevelet's Throne, among the warring souls (Doorish Hills) |
| 2 | the Watchtower of Averost, on a Blood Spear's skeletal veteran (Doorish Hills) |
| 3 | under the offerings at the Cairn of the Last Titan (Doorish Hills) |
| 4 | the Red Sand's Bout Rolls name a fighter buried with one |
| 5 | Mirewraith's Barrow, with the Eternal Blades (Revlend Marshes) |
| 6 | on the next enemy who nearly beats you |

## The Loaded Die

*Cheat · 1st echelon*

*An ivory gambling die with a tiny lead insert that makes it land on 6 roughly two-thirds of the time. Confiscated from a Black Hand card sharp at the Lower Reaches gambling house, then stolen from the evidence shelf at the Golden Knights' outpost. No paperwork exists for it. The card sharp has not stopped looking.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Win a wager against someone who genuinely believed they had the advantage: not a mark, not a fool, but someone who should have won.
- ☐ Stake something you cannot afford to lose.

**Risk.** After the wager, the loser makes an Insight check against your Influence check. If they win, they know the die was loaded, and they name you to the Black Hand card sharp.

**Resource.** Fixes (pip tracker, max 4). Fixes do not refill automatically. To refill: run a game of chance during a Safe Rest and earn at least 1 silver in genuine winnings against an opponent who had a real chance of winning. Gain all 4 Fixes back. Safe Rests where you do not gamble leave the tracker as it is. Fixes return only this way.

POWERS

- Fix (Free, before you roll an attack, spend 1 Fix): Declare you are using the die. Roll your Primary Die twice and take whichever result you prefer. This replaces your Primary Die only; advantage, disadvantage and extra dice from rushing are rolled normally. No memory required, both rolls happen now, in front of everyone.
- Loaded Odds (Passive): Once per session, you may ask the GM whether a creature you can see is bluffing. The die rolls and the GM answers truthfully, but only yes or no.

**Escalation.** When all 4 Fixes are spent, the die gets you anyway. On your next Vicious Opportunist use after depletion, the GM secretly rolls a d6. On a 1-3 the die turns on you: Vicious Opportunist does nothing, and that use is spent, and you do not know until after you have committed. The uncertainty lasts for one use only. Word that a loaded die is back in play reaches the card sharp within a session.

## The Battle Standard of the Nameless King

*Commander · 1st echelon*

*A black iron battle standard, the insignia ground off but the pole still bearing ghost-traces of a name no one can read. Found stacked with other confiscated relics in the Museum of Worlds Beyond storage vault. The curator will not release it without a writ. Three scholars have separately attempted to identify the insignia's origin and stopped work without explanation.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Lead a group of at least five non-party combatants to victory: soldiers, militia, hired swords, anyone you commanded in the field. The victory must be real, a fight that could have been lost.
- [ ] Plant the standard yourself, in plain sight of the enemy.

**Risk.** The first time you plant it, roll a d6. On a 1-3, someone in the watching crowd or the enemy ranks recognizes the standard, and the Knights of the Nameless King send an agent within two sessions.

**Resource.** Authority (pip tracker, max 3). Gain 1 Authority whenever an ally within 4 spaces of the planted standard deals damage in a single attack equal to or greater than your level, at most 1 Authority per attack. Authority is strictly encounter-bound: all unspent pips are lost when combat ends, regardless of how many are held. It cannot be saved or stockpiled between encounters.

POWERS

- Plant it (1 Action): Drive the standard into the ground within Reach 1. While it stands, allies within 4 spaces who can see it have advantage on their first attack each round. Spend 1 Authority to extend the aura by 2 spaces until your next turn.
- Pull it (Free): The standard returns to your hand and the aura ends immediately.
- Hold Ground (Reaction, spend 2 Authority): When the standard would be knocked over, stolen, or destroyed, it refuses. It cannot be moved by any force until the start of your next turn.

**Escalation.** When you plant the standard a second time in one encounter, after it was pulled or knocked over, while Authority is at 0, the insignia becomes briefly legible to everyone present. The GM reads what it says aloud. It goes dark again immediately. What it says is the GM's tool: a name, a title, a command. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| d6 | WHAT THE INSIGNIA SAYS |
|---|---|
| 1 | a name, and a Knight of the Nameless King in the crowd answers to it |
| 2 | a title: the captain of a company that died here |
| 3 | a command: "Hold until I return" |
| 4 | a place: Sevelet's Throne |
| 5 | a date: the next Final Rest of the Nameless King |
| 6 | your own name |

## The Borderlands Tracking Cord

*Hunter · 1st echelon*

*A length of braided sinew hung with small carved tokens: a boot print, a feather, a fang, and three others worn unrecognisable by handling. Carried by a tracker from the Doorish Hills who traded it to a Lower Reaches merchant for safe passage through the Cliffs of the Dead. The merchant did not survive the arrangement.*

UNLOCK

- [ ] Track a single creature across at least two sessions without losing the trail, through city, ruin, or wilderness. The creature must be aware it is being hunted, and must have tried to lose you at least once.

**Risk.** Each session you track the creature, the GM rolls a d6. On a 1, it doubles back and ambushes you, and it acts first in the next encounter.

**Resource.** Marks (d6 vs. accumulation). Your Mark count is the number of quarries the cord currently tracks. Each quarry takes one token, so the cord tracks no more quarries than it has unburned tokens (six to begin with). Roll 1d6 each time you use a cord ability (Mark a Quarry or Cord Pull), before any new Mark is added. If you roll equal to or below your current Mark count, something near the quarry you are marking or pulling noticed you. A Mark clears when you confront that quarry directly (you end a turn adjacent to it, and it is aware of you), and its token is free for a new quarry; or when you Cut its Mark, and its token burns. Resting does not clear Marks.

POWERS

- Mark a Quarry (1 Action): Touch the cord to any physical trace of a creature: a footprint, a drop of blood, shed skin. Add 1 Mark. While that quarry is marked, you know its general direction and distance within 1 mile regardless of cover or concealment. This works on creatures you have not marked with Hunter's Mark, because the cord marks independently of the class ability.
- Cord Pull (Free, 1/encounter): When your marked quarry moves away from you, pull the cord taut. The quarry is Slowed (Speed halved on its next turn). The quarry makes no save, but the cord's d6 still applies. The quarry feels it.
- Cut the Mark (Free): Remove one Mark from the cord and burn its token. The cord forgets that quarry, your sense of its direction ends, and it is no longer tracked. Use this when the pursuit is no longer worth the rising risk. Nothing alerts the quarry.

**Escalation.** When the d6 roll triggers, the quarry, or something near it, begins tracking you in return. The GM introduces this threat within 1 to 2 sessions. The threat is proportional to what you marked: a city rat sends a rat, a Borderlands warlord sends soldiers.

## The Cracked Lens of Kartan

*Mage · 1st echelon*

*A monocle lens of blue glass, cracked through the centre but held in a copper frame that prevents the crack from spreading. Stamped with the Mages of Kartan's maker's mark on the inner rim. The Mages report it stolen. It has been in a Lower Reaches pawn shop for six months, priced too high for anyone who recognised it, too strange for anyone who didn't.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Pay the pawn shop's price, which is more than the lens is worth.
- ☐ Spend a week of downtime studying the crack through the lens, and make an Arcana check, DC 12, to read the maker's mark. On a failure the week is spent and you start over.
- ☐ Then cast a spell of the highest tier you can cast, with the lens held to your eye for the whole cast.

**Risk.** When the cast ends, the crack pulls at your eye. Make an INT save, DC 13. On a failure the lens fails as its Escalation describes: take 1 Wound, the lens fuses to your face for an hour, and Kartan is told. If you flinch or remove the lens, the crack spreads and it is ruined.

**Resource.** Overcharge (d6 vs. accumulation). Roll 1d6 each time you cast a tiered spell while wearing the lens, before the spell resolves. The spell takes effect either way. If you roll equal to or below your current Overcharge, the lens fails after the spell (see Escalation). On a safe roll, add 1 Overcharge once (the +1 printed on each power is that same point, not extra), and apply the one safe-roll power that fits you to this spell: Steady Glass before you choose a subclass, then Controlled Upcast or Chaos Bloom. Overcharge clears when you hold the lens to the glass of the Observatory of Infinite Skies through one night.

POWERS

- Controlled Upcast (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, Control subclass): The spell gains one Upcast for free.
- Chaos Bloom (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, Chaos subclass): If you Invoke Chaos with this spell, roll on the Chaos Table with advantage.
- Steady Glass (on a safe roll, +1 Overcharge, before you choose a subclass): The spell rolls one extra damage die.
- Chaos Sight (Passive, while worn): You see magical auras on creatures and objects within 4 spaces without casting a spell. Illusions appear slightly wrong. Invisible creatures show as a faint shimmer.

**Escalation.** When the d6 triggers, the glass heats to burning. Control Mage: you Lose Control, doing every option on the Control Table, with the GM choosing each time. Chaos Mage: you Invoke Chaos with disadvantage. No subclass yet: you are Dazed until the end of your next turn. Either way you take 1 Wound and cannot remove the lens until the encounter ends, because it has fused to your face. While fused it is inert: no more Overcharge rolls and no safe-roll powers. After the encounter, the Mages of Kartan sense the discharge and know its rough location. They send someone within 1 to 3 sessions. The fusing is now, the visitors are later.

## The Broken Verdict

*Oathsworn · 1st echelon*

*A set of golden scales, one pan snapped off and missing. Recovered from the rubble of an old court in the ruins of Sunken Revvia. The remaining pan still tilts when a lie is spoken nearby, or so the merchant who sold it claimed. She may have been lying. The tilt is subtle enough that you cannot always be certain.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Refuse to deliver a verdict you believe is just, because doing so would protect someone you love.
- ☐ The refusal must be genuine. The Verdict will know if you were simply afraid.

**Risk.** The GM starts a six-step clock for whoever was owed the verdict. It ticks whenever you are seen shielding the person you chose, and when it fills they act against you both.

**Resource.** Held Judgment (toggle, on/off). When your Radiant Judgment would roll Judgment Dice, you may roll them and put them on the scales instead, which turns the toggle on. The scales hold one set of dice at a time, and while they hold it you roll no new Judgment Dice. Held dice stay on the scales past the end of the encounter. The toggle clears when you Release the dice on an attack. If the dice have fused to your Lay on Hands pool (see Escalation), only bringing the scales to the Temple of the Three Sisters clears the fusion.

POWERS

- Hold Judgment (Free, when Judgment Dice would be rolled): Keep the dice on the scales. While they are held, you see the remaining pan tilt when a creature within 6 spaces lies to you, visible only to you. You know. They do not know you know. You must decide what to do with that.
- Release (Free, 1/encounter, on a Reach attack): Expend the held dice as Radiant Judgment normally does. This attack's radiant damage ignores armor.

**Escalation.** If the scales hold dice through a full Safe Rest, they fuse with your Lay on Hands pool. You cannot spend from the pool until the scales are cleared at the Temple of the Three Sisters: you perform a Sacred Decree there or, if you know none yet, a priest there absolves you. The temple will want to know why.

## The Hollow Contract

*Shadowmancer · 1st echelon*

*A slip of black vellum the size of a playing card, written in a language that changes every time you look away. No ink is visible: the text appears to be burned into the material from within. Found pressed between the floorboards of a sealed room in the Lower Reaches, below a building that has been empty for eleven years. The landlord will not say why.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Patron path: commune with your patron during a Safe Rest and ask it for something you know it does not want to give. Accept its counter-demand before you know what it is.
- ☐ Reaver path: you have no patron to ask. Read the vellum by your own shadow, in the room where it was found, for three nights, until the language stops changing.

**Risk.** Patron path: the counter-demand is whatever the GM names, and you have already agreed to it. Reaver path: make a WIL save, DC 12, each night, and each failure starts you with 1 Debt before you have any power. Either way, your patron, or the patron you left, learns the contract has a new reader.

**Resource.** Debt (pip tracker, max 4). Mark Debt each time you use one of the contract's powers, as each power says. Debt above 4 is lost. Debt clears when the patron collects (see Escalation), or when you carry out a sentence you wrote in the contract: write one sentence in your own blood describing something you will do for the patron, then do it. You must write something real, and you must mean it.

POWERS

- Read the Contract (Free, 1/encounter, mark 1 Debt): Hold the vellum up. You see one true fact about a creature you can see: its most urgent want, its deepest fear, or the name of someone it has wronged.
- Patron's Margin (Free, 1/encounter, mark 2 Debt, patron path; every Shadowmancer is on it until choosing a subclass at level 3): You need a use of Pilfered Power (gained at level 2). Spend it to cast a spell from your schools one tier above your current maximum, paying its normal action cost. The patron extends credit.
- Reaver's Margin (Free, 1/encounter, mark 2 Debt, Reaver path): Your next Bonescythe strike this turn rolls one extra d12.

**Escalation.** When Debt reaches 4 or more, the patron collects. It does not take power. It adds one sentence about your character to the contract, permanently. The GM decides what it says and reads it aloud. Debt clears. The sentence stays. A Reaver's contract still answers to the patron they left: that patron writes the sentence, and sends an agent to read it to them in person. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| D6 | THE SENTENCE THE PATRON WRITES |
|---|---|
| 1 | They will refuse help once, when it matters most. |
| 2 | They owe me the name of someone they love. |
| 3 | They will open a door they were told to leave shut. |
| 4 | Their shadow answers to me first. |
| 5 | They will come back to the sealed room. |
| 6 | They will keep one promise I choose, whatever it costs. |

## The Bell of the Three Sisters

*Shepherd · 1st echelon*

*A small iron handbell, tarnished green at the rim, engraved with three interlinked rings. Identical to the bells carried by the clergy of the Temple of the Three Sisters, except that this one rings slightly differently, a half-note flat or sharp depending on who you ask. The temple says it was never consecrated. They are interested in recovering it for study. They have not offered to pay.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Heal a creature you expected, and had good reason, to be your enemy, spending healing that an ally needed.
- ☐ The expectation must be genuine. The bell listens.

**Risk.** The first time you ring it at the Temple of the Three Sisters, the clergy ask who consecrated it. Make an Influence check, DC 14, to answer without lying. On a failure they take the bell for study until you run an errand for them.

**Resource.** Resonance (pip tracker, max 4). Gain 1 Resonance by ringing the bell for an hour over a sickbed or a grave, at the Temple of the Three Sisters or among the tombs of the Cliffs of the Dead, and staying with whoever it is for until the hour ends. Resonance does not clear at a rest. Spent Resonance returns only this way.

POWERS

- Ring Out (Free, spend 1 Resonance): One Dying ally within 6 spaces hears the bell. On its next turn it acts as if it were not Dying: no 1-action limit, and no STR save to attack. It is still Dying, and still takes Wounds from damage.
- Chain Heal (Reaction, spend 2 Resonance): When your Lifebinding Spirit heals a creature to maximum HP, the excess healing carries to the nearest damaged ally within 4 spaces. The chain triggers once per Reaction.
- Toll (1 Action, spend all 4): Ring the bell loudly. All Dying allies within 6 spaces gain 1 HP and are no longer Dying. You take 1 Wound.

**Escalation.** Spending all 4 Resonance in the Toll cracks the bell's handle. It still rings, but you cannot Toll until a clergyperson of the Three Sisters rehandles it. They will want to know what happened before they agree to help.

## The Theater of Whispers Setlist

*Songweaver · 1st echelon*

*A folded sheet of vellum with a handwritten set of songs: titles, keys, and performance notes in the margins in an elegant hand. It belonged to a Songweaver who performed at the Theater of Whispers for fifteen years before disappearing mid-run. The theater kept the setlist. Someone stole it last month. The manager has posted a reward, but is vaguer than expected about what they want to do with whoever took it.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Perform at the Theater of Whispers, or any venue with an audience of 20 or more, and hold the crowd's full attention for an uninterrupted hour. No skill check. Just perform.
- ☐ Find someone who heard the setlist's owner perform, and learn the last song, which has no title.

**Risk.** Someone in that crowd knows the hand that wrote the setlist. Make a Perception check, DC 13, to spot them before they leave. On a failure they find you first, within a session.

**Resource.** Crowd (d6 vs. accumulation, max 4). Each time you Call the Song in combat, roll 1d6 against your current Crowd, then add 1 Crowd. If you roll equal to or below your Crowd before adding, someone recognises the song and has feelings about it: you have disadvantage on your next social roll with a stranger this session. Crowd cannot pass 4; at 4 you cannot Call the Song until it clears. Crowd clears when you play a full uninterrupted hour for a new audience of 20 or more.

POWERS

- Call the Song (Free, in combat, 1/round): Name the song you are playing and roll against your Crowd. The first safe roll each encounter returns 1 spent use of Songweaver's Inspiration.
- Protective Verse (Free, 1/encounter, counts as a Call in every way: combat only, 1/round, roll against your Crowd then add 1; a first safe roll still returns Inspiration): A specific song from the setlist grants immunity to the Taunted or Frightened condition to all allies within 6 spaces until the end of the round.

**Escalation.** When Crowd reaches 4, someone in the crowd knows who this setlist belonged to. They approach between encounters, or send someone. The GM decides who and what they want. They may be a fan. They may not. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| D6 | WHO KNOWS THE SETLIST |
|---|---|
| 1 | the missing Songweaver's apprentice, who wants it back |
| 2 | a creditor the missing Songweaver owed |
| 3 | a Whisperer, selling the story to Roselyn Zeshe |
| 4 | a devoted fan who wants you to finish the set |
| 5 | the thief who stole it last month |
| 6 | the missing Songweaver, in disguise |

## Mud from the Revlend Marshes

*Stormshifter · 1st echelon*

*A sealed clay jar of dark grey mud from the Revlend Marshes north of the city, marked with protective runes no one recognises as any known system. The mud is warm to the touch and smells of rain before a storm. It never dries out. An arch-traveller carried it into the city claiming the marshes spoke to her. She didn't explain further. She is not currently available to explain anything.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Spend a full night alone in the Revlend Marshes, or in the Deadlands adjacent to them, without shelter or fire.
- ☐ Something in the marshes must acknowledge you before dawn. You will know if it did.

**Risk.** At dawn, make a WIL save, DC 13. On a failure, the marshes keep something small from you (the GM names it: your first name, the color of your eyes, the sound of your laugh) until you carry the jar back and refill it.

**Resource.** Earthpulse (pip tracker, max 4). The jar holds 4 Earthpulse when it is full. Using the mud spends Earthpulse (see Powers). Spent Earthpulse returns only when you carry the jar back to the Revlend Marshes and leave it there overnight. A rest does not refill it.

POWERS

- Apply (1 Action, spend 1 Earthpulse): Smear the mud on yourself or a willing creature. While it is applied, the creature cannot be pushed, thrown, or moved by non-magical forced movement. Mud washes off in rain or after a Field Rest.
- Extend the Beastshift (Free, spend 2 Earthpulse, once per Beastshift): Until the end of this encounter, casting spells does not end your Beastshift. It still ends at 0 HP or when you end it.
- Mire (1 Action, spend all 4): Create a 3-space radius of difficult terrain centered on you that lasts until the end of the encounter. The ground thickens and pulls. Any creature that starts its turn in the mire is Slowed.

**Escalation.** When the jar is empty, mud already applied does not dry, but no new mud can be applied until the jar is refilled. If the jar breaks, the mud it held dries at once and all its effects end. A skilled craftsperson can repair a broken jar, but the marshes must still refill it. Each time you return to refill it, the marshes have changed, and the GM says how. Roll a d6 on the table below, or choose.

| D6 | HOW THE MARSHES HAVE CHANGED |
|---|---|
| 1 | the water has risen, and Heron's Stride stands on its last stilts |
| 2 | a path of stones now leads to where you slept |
| 3 | the GM reveals one step of the Revlend Marshes' Neglect clock |
| 4 | something has left a gift where you leave the jar |
| 5 | the mud smells of a different storm: the next refill takes two nights |
| 6 | Revlenders ask you to carry a message back to the city |

## The Pain Teacher's Wrappings

*Zephyr · 1st echelon*

*Linen hand wrappings, yellowed and stained, covered in faded ink annotations, technique notes in a script that predates the city. Found in a locked case in the Lower Reaches beneath a martial arts studio that has been occupied by different teachers for four centuries. Each teacher added their own notes in the margins. The last teacher's annotations stop mid-sentence, mid-technique.*

UNLOCK

- ☐ Study the wrappings' first annotation for a week of downtime.
- ☐ Then take a hit in combat that you could have Defended but deliberately chose not to, in order to observe how the attack was made. The choice must be your own. The wrappings can tell the difference between courage and negligence.

**Risk.** If the hit drops you to 0 HP, the wrappings do not count it. You take the Wound and must try again after you recover. The last teacher's notes stop mid-technique, and whoever silenced them hears the wrappings are in use.

**Resource.** Strain (Wound-cost). Each annotation you use costs 1 Wound. There is no tracker, only the Wounds. A Medical Kit, healing magic and other effects cannot remove these Wounds; they heal only by Safe Rest, 1 per rest. Mark them apart on your Wound track. You cannot use an annotation at 5 Wounds, because the cost would be your sixth.

POWERS

- Study the Form (Free, spend 1 Wound, 1/encounter): Before you attack a creature, spend 1 Wound to activate the wrappings' oldest annotations. For the rest of the encounter, your attacks against that creature ignore its armor. You are choosing to hurt yourself to learn faster.
- Deepest Annotation (Free, spend 1 Wound, 1/Safe Rest): Your unarmed and melee weapon attacks deal bonus damage equal to your level for the rest of the encounter.
- Study (downtime, 1 hour per Safe Rest): Spend an hour reading the annotations during rest. Roll Lore DC 8 to learn something about a martial tradition relevant to the current adventure arc. The GM provides one true detail.

**Escalation.** If you use either annotation while you have 3 or more Wounds, from any source, the wrappings tighten around your hands: the annotation still works, then take 1 additional Wound (it cannot be your sixth: at 5 Wounds you drop to 0 HP and fall Dying instead) and you cannot use either annotation until your next Safe Rest. The annotations become illegible until a skilled martial artist re-inks them. Finding one is the GM's hook.

# Forge an arcanum



## Forge an arcanum

*for a new card in play, or a gap in the deck*

1. **Object.** d30, or d4: on a 1 add a material, on a 2 make it an amulet instead.
2. **Nature.** A kind of magic and an element.
3. **Lore lives in** one source (d8). Examining it rolls d6 on the clue table.
4. **Ritual.** Two different unlock deeds (d7) and a risk (d5).
5. **Resource.** A name (d10), a size (d4: 3, 3, 4, 5) and a refill (d7).
6. **Power** (d8), a **quirk** that's always on (d10), and an **escalation** (d13).
7. **Name it in play**, and check it against the deck's design rules before it reaches the table.

## Material

| D10 | MATERIAL |
|---|---|
| 1 | bone, light and brittle, and the dead notice it |
| 2 | bronze, old and green, and older than the city |
| 3 | coral, still growing |
| 4 | obsidian, sharp enough to cut shadows |
| 5 | red steel, light and hot to the touch |
| 6 | petrified wood that remembers being a tree |
| 7 | silver, soft but feared |
| 8 | dragon, and the dragon's kin can smell it |
| 9 | gold, too heavy to be practical, and everyone wants it |
| 10 | crystal that rings when danger is near |

## Amulet

*d11 each*

| D11 | MATERIAL | SHAPE | ENGRAVING |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | bone | bar | star signs |
| 2 | copper | diamond | a coiled wyrm |
| 3 | crystal | disc | an open eye |
| 4 | obsidian | hand | a leaf-faced man |
| 5 | cloudy gemstone | hexagon | a griffon |
| 6 | tarnished silver | jagged shard | a leering face |
| 7 | ice that never melts | octagon | sigils no one can read |
| 8 | cold iron | ring | a magic square |
| 9 | platinum | saint's effigy | sun and moon |
| 10 | solid shadow | teardrop | runes |
| 11 | black wood | twisted knot | a skull wound with roses |

## Nature

| D8 | ELEMENT |
|---|---|
| 1 | void |
| 2 | death and darkness |
| 3 | fire, metal and smoke |
| 4 | earth, stone and root |
| 5 | water, ice and mist |
| 6 | air, wind and storm |
| 7 | life and light |
| 8 | stars |

| 1–9 | MAGIC |
|---|---|
| 1 | necromancy |
| 2 | destruction |
| 3 | summoning |
| 4 | glamour |
| 5 | artifice |
| 6 | transformation |
| 7 | warding and binding |
| 8 | healing |
| 9 | divination |

## Lore

| D8 | SOURCE |
|---|---|
| 1 | a book in a dead language |
| 2 | an Archkeeper who wants something in return |
| 3 | the ghost of its last owner |
| 4 | a riddle carved on its own surface |
| 5 | a hermit who claims to have made it |
| 6 | a song nobody sings anymore |
| 7 | a rival who already knows, and is ahead of you |
| 8 | the command word, lost; only a sage or divination will find it |

**Clue (d6).** 1 where it was last seen. 2 when it was last seen. 3 a story about someone who used it. 4 a book or sage who knows of it. 5 who made it, or how it came to be. 6 one of its powers.

## Ritual

| 1–7 | UNLOCK |
|---|---|
| 1 | return it to the place it was made |
| 2 | learn its maker's name from someone who would rather not say |
| 3 | spend a full night with it at an arch |
| 4 | carry it through the Lower Reaches without light |
| 5 | get an Archkeeper to write it in the records |
| 6 | bury it for three days and dig it up yourself |
| 7 | let a stranger hold it and tell you what they see |

| 1–5 | RISK |
|---|---|
| 1 | something comes through before you can close the way |
| 2 | STR DC 14 or take 1 Wound from the backlash |
| 3 | it marks you instead, and you have a week before it comes calling |
| 4 | it cracks, and only a skilled artisan can mend it before it wakes |
| 5 | a faction notices, and its clock ticks |

## Resource

| D10 | NAME |
|---|---|
| 1 | Breath |
| 2 | Debt |
| 3 | Hunger |
| 4 | Heat |
| 5 | Strain |
| 6 | Sand |
| 7 | Tally |
| 8 | Silence |
| 9 | Ash |
| 10 | Blood |

| 1–7 | REFILL |
|---|---|
| 1 | regain all at a Safe Rest spent where the object was made |
| 2 | regain 1 when you give something you love to a stranger |
| 3 | regain 1 when you tell someone a true secret about yourself |
| 4 | regain all after a whole night spent in a grave, a tomb or a cistern, not passing through |
| 5 | regain 1 when you keep a promise that costs you |
| 6 | regain 1 when someone else freely bleeds on it |
| 7 | it never refills, and it is spent for good |

## Power

| D8 | POWER (RES IS THE RESOURCE) |
|---|---|
| 1 | Reaction, 1 RES: when an ally within 6 spaces is hit, take the hit instead and halve it |
| 2 | Action, 1 RES: one creature you can see is Frightened until the end of its next turn, WIL DC 13 negates |
| 3 | Action, 1 RES: ask the GM one question about the place you stand; the answer is true |
| 4 | Free, 1 RES, 1/round: teleport to a spot you can see within 4 spaces |
| 5 | Action, 1 RES: an object you touch is unbreakable for an hour |
| 6 | Reaction, 1 RES: reroll one of your own dice; keep the new result |
| 7 | Action, 1 RES: for one minute you see in total darkness and spot the invisible |
| 8 | Action, 1 RES: speak with the dead body you touch, three questions |

## Quirk

| D10 | QUIRK |
|---|---|
| 1 | Fires within a few steps of you gutter and die. |
| 2 | Animals bristle at you and won't come close. |
| 3 | You have no sense of smell while it is on you. |
| 4 | People near you sleep badly. |
| 5 | Holy water goes flat in your presence. |
| 6 | Gems you touch cloud over. |
| 7 | Cut flowers wilt in your hands. |
| 8 | You smell faintly of something wrong. |
| 9 | You can't see well when it is more than a few steps away. |
| 10 | Spells find you easily: disadvantage on saves against magic. |

# Escalation

| 1–13 | ESCALATION |
|---|---|
| 1 | The object chooses a champion. It starts to change your body to keep itself safe; the GM names one change each time it empties. |
| 2 | Something has been following the object for a long time. When it empties, it arrives, and it can look like anyone. |
| 3 | Your fingertips blacken. Each time it empties, the black climbs higher, and it grants one boon and one oddity. |
| 4 | It stores your pain. When it empties, take every Wound you avoided since you last emptied it. |
| 5 | You stop aging. When it empties, a year catches up with you all at once. |
| 6 | It goes silent for a season. What it knows is locked away until a ritual wakes it. |
| 7 | It shatters, and the shards go into your flesh. You keep the power, and it keeps you. |
| 8 | You are branded. Those who carry arcana of their own can see the mark. |
| 9 | You can't bring yourself to put it down. If it is taken, you will hunt for it. |
| 10 | It must be fed each week. Miss a week, and it feeds on whoever is closest. |
| 11 | It gets heavier after every fight, until you shed what it has caught. |
| 12 | Water undoes it. A soaking costs it 1 RES, and it can't be used while wet. |
| 13 | An order that hates its kind attacks you on sight. |

# Object

*d30*

| 1–30 | OBJECT |
|---|---|
| 1 | a carved bone that catches fire once a day |
| 2 | a wolf idol that floats wherever it is set down |
| 3 | a dried rose that turns toward the nearest arch |
| 4 | a cold iron spike that smells of poison near poison |
| 5 | a warped skull that drips blood near the dead |
| 6 | a cracked mirror that sings a lullaby when rattled |
| 7 | a severed finger whose owner wants it back |
| 8 | a black candle that fey cannot stand |
| 9 | a ring of daisies that never wilts |
| 10 | a faded locket that is warm when someone lies |
| 11 | a shard of blue glass that shows brief portents |
| 12 | a bronze oil lamp with a faded inscription |
| 13 | a jade comb that once pardoned a crime |
| 14 | a torn half of a map, the other half somewhere in the city |
| 15 | a silver lion on a braided chain, taken in a raid |
| 16 | a gold rose dotted with rubies, from a sacked chapel |
| 17 | a coffer of coins stamped with a dead king's face |
| 18 | a rusted compass whose needle draws blood |
| 19 | a stick of damp chalk |
| 20 | a pair of glass eyes in a velvet case |
| 21 | a lantern shield with a cracked lens |
| 22 | a skin-stretched shield, light as a basket |
| 23 | a chain-scythe wrapped in prayer cloth |
| 24 | a sun-and-moon blade with one edge dulled |
| 25 | a fighting fan with names painted on the ribs |
| 26 | a jitte that catches more than blades |
| 27 | a speargun built for a hand that wasn't human |
| 28 | a chakram that never quite stops spinning |
| 29 | a war rake from a peasant army that won |
| 30 | a coat of overlapping coins, half of them forged |

# Sheets *appendix C · copy freely*

# Sejr

NAME | CLASS | ANCESTRY | LEVEL

## Stats

STR ☐ — *gift*

DEX ☐ — *gift*

INT ☐ — *gift*

WIL ☐ — *gift*

HP ☐ max ☐ Wounds ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

## Traits

*Invoke a gift or trait once per episode for advantage. Suffer a trait: disadvantage, tick your ritual.*

## Specialties

## Life events

Origin — *tie*

Youth — *tie*

Recent — *tie*

## Holding or guild

*Guild rank: Apprentice* ☐ *Journeyman* ☐ *Master* ☐

## Look · habit · mark · secret

## Arcanum

*Unexamined until the ritual wakes it. University: Novice* ☐ *Reader* ☐ *Wielder* ☐ *Cracker* ☐

Ritual ☐ ☐ ☐ Resource ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ legacy bonus ☐ ☐ ☐

## Gear and notes

*Absent this week: tick your ritual, make one off-screen refill.*

# Sejr

*campaign trackers · GM only*

RENOWN _____ AVG LEVEL _____ EPISODE _____

## Thread board

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | 2 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | 3 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |
| 4 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | 5 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | 6 ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |

## Patrons

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Archkeepers** | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | ☐ Welcoming · ☐ wary · ☐ gatekeeping |
| **Black Hand** | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | ☐ Errands · ☐ entangled · ☐ owned |
| **Golden Council** | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | ☐ Contracting · ☐ auditing · ☐ conscripting |
| **University** | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ | ☐ Open lectures · ☐ licensing · ☐ monopoly |

## Factions, bands, rival crews

☐☐☐☐☐☐

☐☐☐☐☐☐

☐☐☐☐☐☐

☐☐☐☐☐☐

☐☐☐☐☐☐

## Neglect hidden

| | |
|---|---|
| Revlend Marshes | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |
| Doorish Hills | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |
| Deadlands | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |
| Borderlands | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |
| Lower Reaches | ☐☐☐☐☐☐ |

## Rival crews met

| CREW | MET | TRACKER | NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|
| | ☐☐ | ☐ | |
| | ☐☐ | ☐ | |
| | ☐☐ | ☐ | |

## Key-making front

Find ☐ _____ Read ☐ _____ Make ☐ _____

## Last time

# Sejr

*episode run sheet*

EPISODE _____ PLAYERS _____ DOOR _____

## 1 · Last time

## 2 · Door

City ☐ Arch ☐ Thread ☐

## 3 · Where

Stage d6 + renown = ☐

*Neglect ticks on:*

## 4 · The job

*But*

*Patron, debt, and what success means to them*

## 5 · Map

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |

## 6 · But+ at each scene change

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

## 7 · Close

Thread closed _____ Thread opened _____

Renown +1 ☐ Absent ticked ☐ Neglect advanced ☐ Milestone ☐